

A Course in English Pronunciation

by

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PREFACE

A Course in English Pronunciation presents the material to understand phonetics in the form of forty four units. Each unit has notes and examples which combines learners to understand in the most practical manner. This book has been designed to impart the nature of changing patterns in English pronunciation. It also describes in detail forty four instructional features of the sounds. It aims at multidimensional teaching-learning process: a dual focus on communication skills, learners goals, instructional objectives, the role of the learners, the role of the teachers, and a framework of dimension instructional practice mode.

It is intent of this book to approach the pronunciation learning with the spirit of optimism. I am confident that the book will help all the students because of its Pragmatic approach.

This book would not have been possible without the background help and motivation of Fr. Brian Pereira SJ, the Director St. Joseph's Evening College and Dr. Albert Smith, the principal, St. Joseph's Evening College. A special thanks due to Prof. Mukesh Soni and Ms. Sharanya Francis for editing this book.

I will be grateful to you for all the suggestions for the improvement of this book and it will be appreciatively acknowledged.

- Author

Diwakar P Yadav

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Introduction

The purpose of the study of English Phonetics is to help the students to improve their pronunciation of English words as also their intonation in connected speech and conversation so that they may be intelligible in English. Phonetics is concerned with the aural medium addressed to the ear. J.C. Catford denies that phonetics is a systematic study of human speech sounds. It provides means of analyzing, classifying and describing virtually all the sounds that can be produced by human vocal tracts.

The knowledge of phonetics is useful in the following areas; second language teaching, acting, speech pathology, communication, and speech science.

Three Approaches to the Study of Phonetics

The below three approaches or methods to study of speech sounds can be practically termed as the three branches of phonetics.

1. Auditory Phonetics
2. Articulatory Phonetics
3. Acoustic Phonetics

Auditory Approach

People use the terms descriptive of speech sounds which are almost exclusively auditory. They rely mainly on what one could feel of his own speech and other's speech i.e. his impression. According to this approach, phonetics is one which must be learnt by a period of apprenticeship. This is a 'subjective' method of analysis of speech sounds by sensory impression.

Acoustic Approach

Acoustic, a branch of Physics, measures the vibrations of air molecules which we call sound waves. They are expressed in mathematical terms; they might well be adopted by linguists. But the problem in the use of strictly acoustic terminology presupposes extensive training in physics and mathematics. Further, it depends on the use of special laboratory apparatus which again few linguists are equipped to handle. In short, acoustic terms, for all their precision, are meaningless to nearly every linguist (Bloch and Tranger 1972).

Articulatory Approach

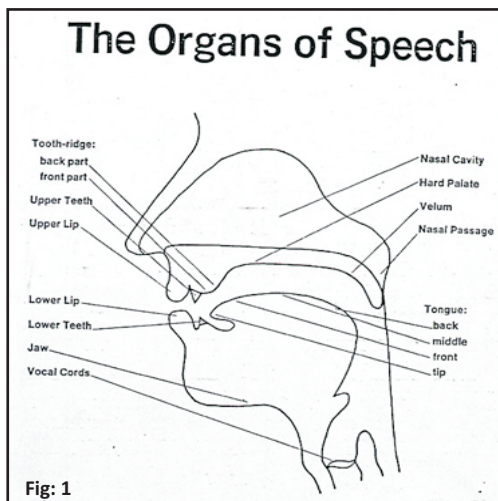
The movements and positions of vocal organs can be learnt without previous special training. Any sound can be unambiguously and simply described in terms of the movements which produce it; lips, tongue, palate and so on form the laboratory apparatus for this approach.

The Organs of Speech

What we call 'the vocal organs' or 'the organs of speech' - lungs, vocal cords, tongue, lips, etc are not primarily organs of speech at all. The primary duties of these organs are connected with physiological, functions such as breathing, chewing, swallowing, etc.

To understand the nature of speech and the means by which it is produced, let us have a brief idea of the structure and the functions of the various organs of speech.

In all our utterances we speak with the air coming out of our lungs. The air that flows out of our mouth is modified into speech sounds by the action of certain organs of our body. We, therefore call those organs the organs of speech. They are as follows.



- The lungs and the trachea
- The larynx and the vocal cords
- The palate or the roof of the mouth
- The lips
- The teeth
- The tongue

The lungs and the trachea: While the lungs, the chest muscles and trachea together make the respiratory system, the other speech organs may be said to form the phonatory system. The air stream that comes out of our lungs is the basis of speech sounds before it passes into atmosphere.

The larynx and the vocal cords: the air released by the lungs comes up through the wind pipe and arrives first in the larynx. The larynx contains two small bands of elastic tissues which can be thought of as flat strips of rubber, lying opposite to each other across the air passage. These are called vocal cords. When the inner edges of the vocal cords are moved towards each other so that they meet and completely cover top of the wind pipe. In their second position they are drawn apart so that there is a gap between them (the gap is known as the glottis) through which the air can pass freely. This is their usual position when we are asleep breathing air quietly in and out.

(Left) With the vocal cords completely closed, as for a glottal stop [ʔ]:



Fig: 2

(Right) With the vocal cords wide open, as during quiet respiration preceding speech. the "bumps" of (Note ho the arytenoids cartilages are held apart, e tissue taut):

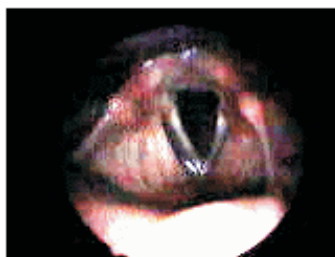


Fig: 3

When the vocal cords are brought together tightly, no air can pass through them. The result is that the air from below is compressed and so it bursts out with a sort of noise called 'voice'. So, when the vocal cords brought close together and the air is forced between them, they vibrate, producing the sound known as voice. But when they are wide apart and the air passes between them, the little sound produced is called breath. The sound /h/ is pure breath, voice is heard in many sounds particularly in the vowels.

Ordinary speech sounds require either breath or voice in their articulation. Those that contain breath are breathed or voiceless and those that contain voice are called voiced sounds. Examples of breathed sounds are /p/, /f/, /h/ etc. while those of voiced sounds are /b/, /d/, /g/ etc.

The distinction between the voiced and voiceless sounds is this; if the throat is touched at larynx a distinct vibration is felt if voiced sounds are

pronounced but not covered by hands, a loud buzzing sound can be heard. But this is not the case when the breathed sounds are uttered.

The air stream from the lungs passes through an opening between the vocal cords, the glottis

If the vocal cords are apart and the airstream is not obstructed at the glottis, the sounds produced this way are voiceless.

If the vocal cords are together and the airstream forces its way through, the vocal cords vibrate and the sounds produced this way are **voiced**:

The articulatory system :

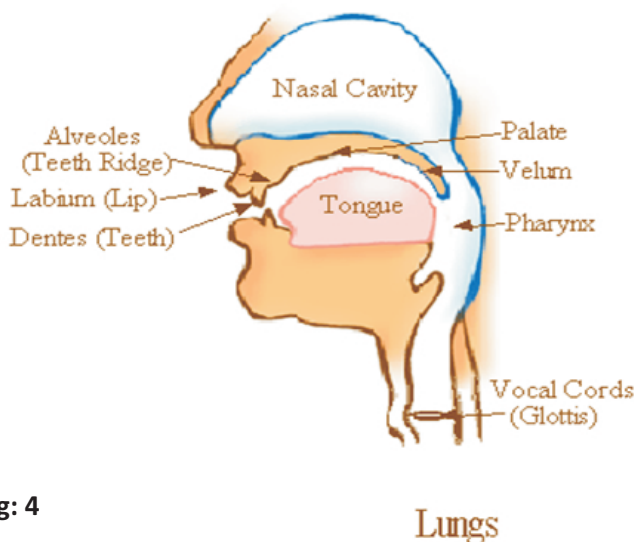


Fig: 4

The Palate:

After passing through the larynx, the air stream is further modified by the various shapes assumed by the organs of speech viz the lips, the teeth ridge, the palate and the tongue. The palate is the roof of the mouth. It is divided into two parts, the front part consisting of hard palate and the back part consisting of the soft palate. The foremost part of the palate which is convex to the tongue is called the teeth-ridge. It extends from the back of the upper front teeth to the point where the palate ceases to be convex to the tongue and begins to be concave.

Mouth (Oral Cavity)

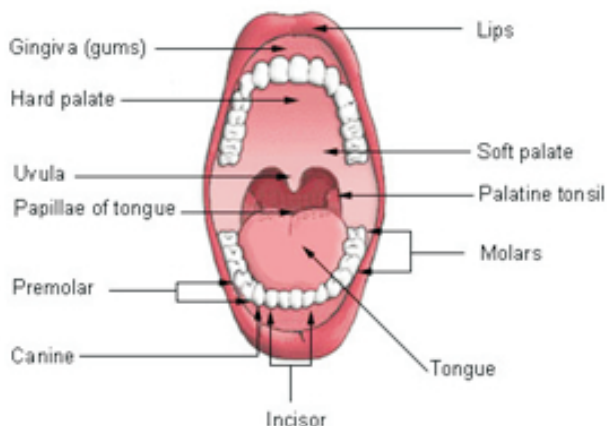


Fig: 5

Soft & Hard Palate

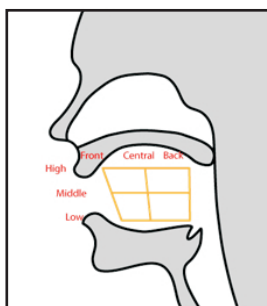
The soft part of the palate curving towards the tongue becomes narrower until it ends in a point called Uvula. Behind the soft palate lies the back wall of the pharynx. The soft palate can move, when is raised, it makes a firm contact with the back wall of the pharynx this stops the breath from going up into the nasal cavity and forces it to go into the mouth only. The soft palate moves quickly upwards so that all the breath comes out of the mouth and none of it goes up into its lowest position, it allows the breath to pass behind itself and up into the nasal cavity and out through the nose. This is the normal position of the soft palate when we are not speaking but breathing quietly through the nose, with our mouth closed. This position is also for the formation of the sounds /m/, /n/, /k/.

The Alveolar Ridge: the alveolar ridge is the part of the gum immediately behind the upper front teeth. The hard palate which is the highest part of the palate lies between the alveolar ridge and the beginning of the soft palate. The alveolar ridge is especially important in English because many of the consonants like /t/, /d/, /n/, /r/, /s/, /z/, / f/, /ʃ/, /ʒ/, /tʃ/, /dʒ/, are made with tongue touching the alveolar ridge. The palate curves downwards towards the teeth at each side.

The Teeth: Among the teeth, the lower front teeth are not important

for the purpose of speech except that they are helpful in making the /s/, /z/ sounds. But the upper front teeth are used in English to some extent e.g. in making the [θ] and [ð] dental sounds as in 'thin' & 'this' as also in making /f/, and /v/ sounds.

The Tongue: The tongue is most important organ of speech because it makes the great variety of movements in making many sounds. We need to consider the several parts of the tongue that are used in making a variety of sounds. Articulation from tongue divides into different parts: tip, blade, front, back and root.



The lips are important in speech. They also take up various positions; they can be brought firmly together as pronouncing bilabial sounds /p/ and /b/. In this position they completely block the mouth. But in pronouncing labiodentals sounds /f/ and /v/, the lower lip can be drawn inward and slightly upward to touch the upper front teeth. Again in pronouncing /i:/, /u/ and /u:/ lips are kept apart and kept with different degree of rounding respectively. They are also pushed forward to a greater or lesser extent.

Three Dimensions of Articulation

- Voicing
- Place of Articulation
- Manner of Articulation

Places of Articulation

- Labials (bilabials, labiodentals)
- Alveolar
- Velars
- Inter dentals
- Palatals
- Glottal

Labials

[b], [p], [m], [f] and [v] are labials

When we produce [b], [p], or [m], we articulate them by bringing together both lips. These speech sounds are called bilabials

When we produce [f] and [v], we articulate by touching the bottom lip to the upper teeth. These speech sounds are called labiodentals

Alveolars

[t], [d], [s], [z], [n], and [l] are alveolar. When we produce these sounds we raise the tip of our tongue toward the hard palate and touch the alveolar ridge. These speech sounds are called alveolars

When we produce [f] and [v], we articulate by touching the bottom lip to the upper teeth. These speech sounds are called labiodentals

Velars

[k], [g], [ŋ], [w] are velars. When we produce these sounds we raise the back of our tongue toward the soft palate or the velum. These speech sounds are called velars.

Interdentals

[θ] and [ð] are interdentals.

When we produce these sounds we insert the tip of our tongue between the upper and the lower teeth. These speech sounds are called interdentals.

Palatals

/ʃ/, /ʒ/, /tʃ/, /dʒ/ are palatals.

When we produce these sounds we raise the front part of our tongue to a point on the hard palate just behind the alveolar ridge. These speech sounds are called palatals.

Manners of Articulation

Stops	}	Obstruents
Fricatives		
Affricates		
Nasals	}	Sonorants
Liquids		
Glides		

Obstruents

An obstruent is a consonant sound formed by obstructing the outward airflow, causing increased air pressure in the vocal tract. Obstruents are those articulations in which there is a total closure or a stricture causing friction. Obstruents are subdivided into stops, fricatives, and affricates.

Sonorants

Sonorants are those articulations in which there is only a partial closure or an unimpeded oral or nasal escape of air. English has the following sonorant consonantal phonemes: /l/, /m/, /n/, /k/, /r/, /w/, /j/

Stops (plosives)

When the air stream enters the oral cavity it may be stopped, obstructed, or flow freely.

When the air is completely stopped for a brief period of time, these speech sounds are called stops.

[b], [p], [t], [d], [k] and [g] are stops.

Fricatives

When the air is not stopped completely but is obstructed from flowing freely, these speech sounds are called fricatives. Examples: [h], [ʃ], [ʒ], [s], [z], [f], [v], [θ] and [ð]

Affricates

Some sounds are produced by a stop closure followed immediately a slow release of the closure as in a fricative. These speech sounds are called affricates.

[ʃ] and [ʒ] are affricates.

Nasals

A nasal consonant is produced with a lowered velum in the mouth, allowing air to escape freely through the nose. The oral cavity still acts as a resonance chamber for the sound, but the air does not escape through the mouth as it is blocked by the tongue.

[m], [n] and [ŋ] are nasals.

Liquids

When there is some obstruction of the air stream but not enough to cause friction, these speech sounds are called liquids.

[l] and [r] are liquids.

Glides

When there is little or no obstruction of the air stream in the mouth, these speech sounds are called glides or semi-vowels

[j] and [w] are glides.

Place, State and Manner of Articulation

		MANNER	VOICING	PLACE					
				Bilabial	Labiodental	Interdental	Alveolar	Palatal	Velar
OBSTRUENTS	Stop	Voiceless	p			t		k	ʔ
		Voiced	b			d		g	
	Fricative	Voiceless		f	θ	s	ʃ		h
		Voiced		v	ð	z	ʒ		
	Affricate	Voiceless					tʃ		
		Voiced					dʒ		
SONORANTS	Nasal	Voiced	m			n		ŋ	
	LIQUID	Lateral	Voiced			l			
		Rhotic	Voiced				r		
	Glide	Voiced	w				j	w	

Table: 1

The classification of Sounds

The sounds which the organs of speech are mainly of two kinds:

- Vowels
- Consonants

Vowels are voiced sounds that are produced without any obstruction or friction. They are purely musical sounds. All other articulated sounds are consonants which are voiceless and voiced sounds. Some are produced on account of some friction in the mouth caused by the articulators which still others are nasal i.e. produced when the breath passing through nose.

Consonant Phonemes					
21	/p/	<u>p</u> it	33	/m/	<u>m</u> an
22	/b/	<u>b</u> it	34	/n/	<u>n</u> ice
23	/t/	<u>t</u> ime	35	/ŋ/	ri <u>ng</u>
24	/d/	<u>d</u> oor	36	/l/	le <u>g</u>
25	/k/	<u>c</u> at	37	/r/	<u>r</u> at
26	/g/	ge <u>t</u>	38	/w/	<u>w</u> et
27	/f/	<u>f</u> an	39	/h/	<u>h</u> at
28	/v/	<u>v</u> an	40	/j/	ye <u>t</u>
29	/θ/	<u>th</u> ink	41	/ʃ/	<u>sh</u> op
30	/ð/	<u>th</u> at	42	/z/	lei <u>z</u> ure
31	/s/	<u>s</u> end	43	/tʃ/	<u>ch</u> op
32	/z/	<u>z</u> ip	44	/dʒ/	<u>j</u> ump

Table: 2

Vowel Phonemes					
01	/ɪ/	p <u>i</u> t	11	/ɜ:/	<u>g</u> irl
02	/e/	p <u>e</u> t	12	/u:/	<u>to</u> o
03	/æ/	p <u>a</u> t	13	/eɪ/	<u>d</u> ay
04	/ɒ/	p <u>o</u> t	14	/aɪ/	sk <u>y</u>
05	/ʌ/	<u>l</u> uck	15	/ɔɪ/	<u>b</u> oy
06	/ʊ/	<u>g</u> ood	16	/ɪə/	<u>b</u> eer
07	/ə/	<u>a</u> go	17	/eə/	<u>b</u> ear
08	/i:/	m <u>e</u> at	18	/ʊə/	<u>t</u> our
09	/ɑ:/	c <u>a</u> r	19	/əʊ/	<u>g</u> o
10	/ɔ:/	d <u>o</u> or	20	/aʊ/	<u>c</u> ow

Table: 3

The Vowels of English

The vowels of English are all voiced because they are formed by the voiced air passage through different mouth shapes. They are made by different positions of the tongue and the lips. It is therefore convenient to classify the vowels according to the positions of the parts of the tongue. In the production of most of the vowels the tongue is convex to the palate. Vowel, therefore, be conveniently arranged according to the position of the highest point of the tongue. There are front vowels, in the production of which the front of the tongue is raised in the direction of the hard palate as in /i:/ in /fi:/.

Then, there are back vowels, in the production of which the back of the tongue is raised in direction of the soft palate as in saying in /u:/ in /fu:/. Again there are vowels intermediate between front and back. We call them central vowels.

Vowels: There are twenty vowel sounds according to R. P (Received Pronunciation). Twelve of them are pure vowels called monothongs and the remaining eight are called diphthongs.

Tongue Height

Vowels are classified in terms of how much space there is between the tongue and the roof of the mouth, which is determined by the height of the tongue.

There are three primary height distinctions among vowels: high, low, and mid.

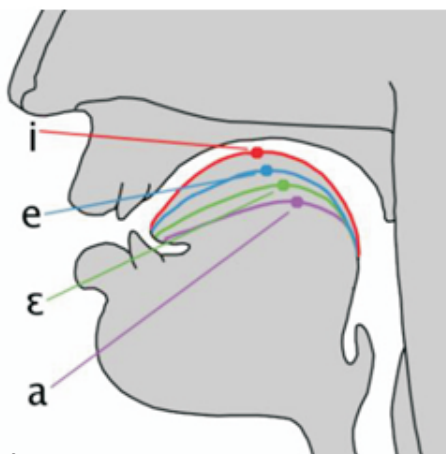


Fig: 7

Tongue Height

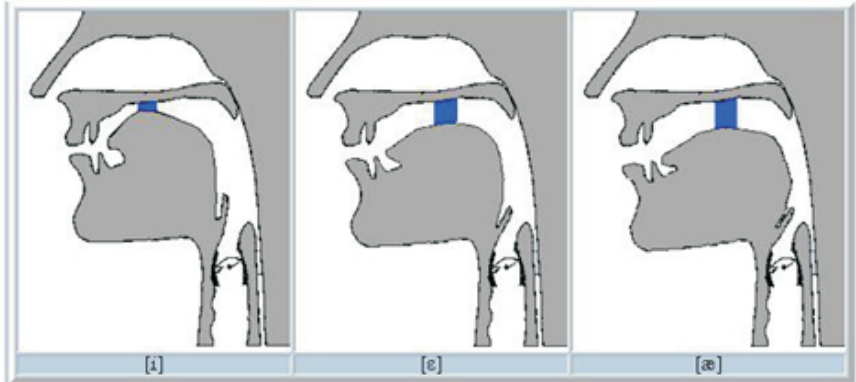


Fig: 8

Tongue backness

Vowels are classified in terms of how far the raised body of the tongue is from the back of the mouth, which is called the backness of the tongue.

There are three primary height distinctions among vowels: front, back, and central.

Tongue Backness

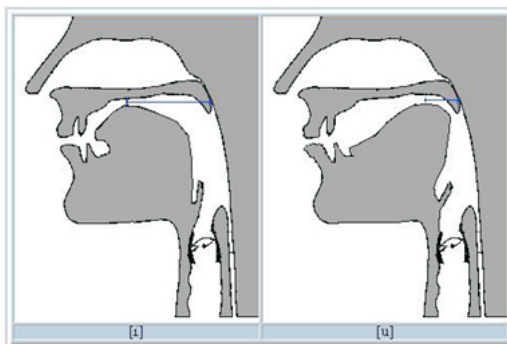


Fig: 9

Monophthongs or Pure Vowels

We know that there are twelve monophthongs in English language which are also known as pure vowels. In the production of these pure vowels the tongue takes just one position. But diphthongs the tongue glides from one position to another.

Monophthongs or Pure Vowels and their Phonetic Symbols:

/i:/ as in been	Front close unrounded vowel.
/ɪ/ as in tin	Central front unrounded, above half close position.
/e/ as in let	Front unrounded vowel between half open and half close position.
/æ/ as in hat	Front unrounded vowel just below the half open position.
/u:/ as in cool	Back close rounded vowel.
/ʊ/ as in full	Centralized back rounded vowel just above the half close position.
/ɔ:/ as in caught	Back rounded vowel between half open and half close position.
/ɒ/ as in God	Back rounded vowel just above the half open position.
/ɑ:/ as in calm	Back open unrounded vowel.
/ɜ:/ as in bird	Central unrounded vowel between half open and half close position.
/ə/ as in a	Central unrounded vowel below the half open position.
/ʊ/ as in cut	Central unrounded vowel just above the open position.

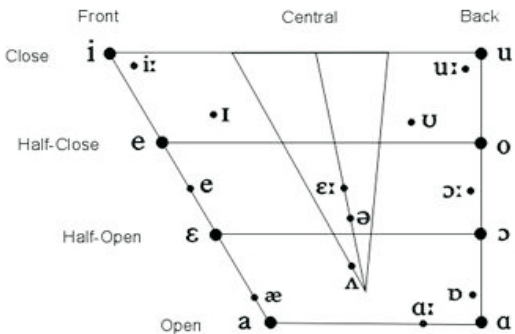


Fig: 10

Position of the Pure Vowels

Pure Vowel Sounds or Monophthongs

International Phonetic Alphabet (O'Connor) Examples

1	i:	see, unique, feel
2	ɪ	wit, mystic, little
3	e	set, meant, bet
4	æ	pat, cash, bad
5	ɑ :	half, part, father
6	ɒ	not, what, cost
7	ɔ:	port, caught, all
8	ʊ	wood, could, put
9	u:	you, music, rude
10	ʊ	bus, come, but
11	ɜ:	beard, word, fur
12	ə	alone, butter

Articulation of Pure Vowels

/i:/

In articulation of /i:/ the front tongue is raised in the direction of the hard palate to a position almost near close. The lips are spread while the tongue is tense.

/ɪ/

It front close unrounded vowel. The lips are loosely spread. It is a short vowel.

/e/

In articulating /e/ the front of the tongue is raised towards the hard palate to a height between half close and half open. Lips are spread loosely and the tongue is tense. Thus /e/ is called a front unrounded vowel between half close-half-open.

/æ/

In forming /æ/ the front part of the tongue is raised towards the hard palate a little below the half open position. Lips are open and neutral.

So /æ/ is front unrounded vowel just below the half open position. /æ/ does not occur in the final position, it occurs only in the initial and medial positions. Example: at /æt/, hat /hæt/ respectively.

/ɑ:/

It back, open, and unrounded vowel. In forming this part of the tongue between the centre and the back, (nearer the back rather than the centre) is in fully open position. The jaws are wide and the lips are neutrally open. /ɑ:/ is thus a back open unrounded vowel. /ɑ:/ can occur initially, medially and finally. Example: ask /ɑ:sk/, tar /tɑ:r/ and car /kɑ:/ respectively.

/ɒ/

The back of the tongue is just above the fully open position. The jaws are wide open and the lips are slightly rounded. /ɒ/ is therefore, a back rounded vowel just above the open position. It occurs only initially and medially in words. Example: ox /ɒks/ and box/bɒks/ respectively.

/ɔ:/

It is relatively longer than /ɒ/. In forming this sound the back of the tongue is raised towards the soft palate. Between the half open and half close positions. The lips are rounded. /ɔ:/ is therefore, described as back rounded vowel between half open and half close positions. /ɔ:/ can appear in initially, medially and finally. Examples: ought /ɔ:t/, brought /brɔ:t/ and lot /lɔ:/.

/u/

In the articulation of this vowel the front part of the back of the tongue is raised towards the soft palate to a height just above half close. The tongue is relaxed and the lips are rounded. /u/ is thus a back rounded vowel just above half close. /u/ does not occur initially, it occurs only medially and finally. Example: put /put/ and to /tu/ respectively.

/u:/

This vowel is relatively longer than /u/. In articulation of /u:/ the back of the tongue is raised in the direction of the soft palate as high as very near the close position. The lips are closely rounded and tongue is tense. /u:/ is back, close rounded vowel. /u:/ can occur in any position, initially, medially and finally. Example: use /u:z/, loot /lu:t/ and menu /menju:/

/ʊ/

In the articulation of this central vowel, the centre of the tongue is raised towards that part of the palate which is between the hard palate and the soft palate. The central part is raised to a height just above the open position. The jaws are wide and the lips are neutral and open. The vowel occurs initially and medially. Example: up /ʊp/ and cup /kʊp/ respectively.

/ɜ:/

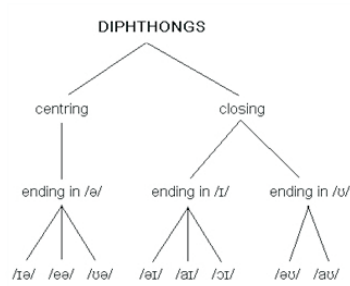
In articulating this central vowel the tongue raised in the direction of that part of the palate which is between the hard palate and soft palates. The tongue goes to a height between half close and half open. The lips are spread, /ɜ:/ is central unrounded. /ɜ:/ occurs in any position, initially, medially and finally. Example: early /ɜ:li/, bird /bɜ:d/ and burn /bɜ:n/ respectively.

/ə/

In articulating of the sound /ə/ the central part of the tongue is raised to a height just below the half open position when it occurs in the final position as in /ti:tʃə/. It has the same manner of articulation as in vowel /ɜ:/. It is the most frequently used vowel in English pronunciations. It can occur in any position, initially, medially and finally. Examples: /əbəut/, /fa:mə/ and /pleiə/.

Diphthongs or Vowel Glides

Diphthongs are also called vowel glides, as in the articulation of them the tongue starts for the position of a particular vowel and moves or glides within one syllable. The starting point is called the first element of the diphthong and the other vowel towards which the glide takes place is called its second element.



IPA (O'Connor)

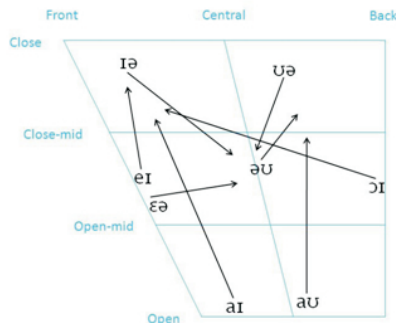
13	eɪ	lady, make
14	əɪ	go, home
15	aɪ	my, time
16	aɪ	now, round
17	ɔɪ	boy, noise
18	ɪə	here, beard
19	eə	fair, scarce
20	ɪə	pure, your

Examples

Articulation of Diphthongs or Vowel Glides

/eɪ/

The front of the tongue starts from a point just below the half close position and moves in the towards the position /i/, /eɪ/ can be described as a glide from unrounded vowel. The lips are spread. The diphthong is a glide from a front unrounded vowel just above half close /eɪ/ occurs in energy position- initially, medially and finally. Examples: aid /eɪd/, say /seɪ/ and pay /peɪ/.



/aɪ/

In the articulation of this diphthong, the glide starts from a point from a point just behind the front open position and moves towards the position of /i/. /aɪ/. The lips are neutral at the beginning but become loosely spread in the end. The jaws are wide open in the beginning but become narrow when gliding at the second element /i/. /aɪ/ can occur initially, medially and finally. Example: hi /aɪ/, kite /kaɪt/ and sky /skaɪ/.

/ɪɪ/

In the articulation of this diphthong the glide begins at a point near back half open. It moves in the direction of /i/. /ɪɪ/. The jaws are slightly wide in the beginning but are narrow towards end. Lips too are rounded in the beginning but are loosely spread at the end. /ɪɪ/ can occur initially, medially and finally. Example: /ɪɪ/, boy /bɪɪ/, and toy /tɪɪ/.

/ɪ ɪ /

In the articulating this diphthong the glide begins at a central position between half close and half open and it moves in the direction of /u/. In the beginning they become rounded. Naturally /ɪ ɪ / is a glide from a central unrounded vowel between half close and half open to a centralized back rounded vowel above the half close position. /ɪ ɪ / occurs initially, medially and finally. Example: over /ɪ ɪ vɪ /, goes /gɪ ɪ z/ and go /gɪ ɪ /.

/aɪ /

In the articulation of this diphthong, the glide starts from the point of articulation of the /ɑ ɪ/ vowel and moves from towards the position of /u/. Thus /aɪ / can be described as a glide from back open unrounded position to a centralized back rounded vowel just above the half close position.

/ɪɪ/

In articulating this diphthong the glide begins from /i/ moving towards /ɪ/. Lips are spread during both elements of this diphthong. Central unrounded vowel between half close and half open position, the position for the articulation while final /ɪɪ/ has the same starting but it glides in the direction of a centralized unrounded vowel just half open. /ɪɪ/ occurs initially, medially and finally. Examples: ear /ɪɪ/, fears /fɪɪz/, and fear /fɪɪ/.

/ɪ ɪ/

In articulating this diphthong, the glide starts with the tongue position similar to that of /u/. The glide moves in the direction of non-final /ɪ/ if the diphthong occurs finally in a word. The lips are rounded in the beginning but spread towards the end /ɪ ɪ/ is therefore, a glide from a centralized back rounded vowel just above half close to a central unrounded vowel between half close and half open position as in tour /tɪ ɪ/. /ɪ ɪ/ occurs only medially and finally.

/eə /

In this diphthong, the glide begins in the front half open position, moving towards the non-final /ə/. The lips are neutral throughout. /eə/ is a glide from a front half close and half open unrounded vowel to a central unrounded vowel between half close and half open if the diphthong is non-final. /eə/ occurs in all the three positions, initially, medially and finally. Example: /eə/, /beəz/, and /beə/.

The Phoneme and The Syllable Structure

The Phoneme

A phoneme is the smallest distinctive speech sound in a language. It distinguishes one sound from another. In English there are 24 consonant phonemes. Examples: the /s/ in /si:/ and /z/ in /zu:/ represent two different phonemes. We produce continuous stream of sounds when we speak. Each stream is a segment. Example: the word 'sat' is pronounced with first segment /s/, a second segment /æ/ and the third segment /t/.

The human speech mechanism is capable of producing an infinite number of speech sounds. Every language makes its own selection from this vast number of human sounds, and this selection makes its particular sound system. But all these sounds are not significant from the purpose of some meaning. Naturally we study only those sounds that make a meaningful difference between words and help us to communicate between individuals speaking a particular language.

Since Phonetics is the study of speech sounds and their production, a phonetician can tell us even about the small difference between the two sounds of single phoneme. For example the two possible sounds of /p/ in the word Phillips /fɪlɪps/. The first /p/ is aspirated while the second /p/ is pronounced. Hence phonemes are smallest distinctive sounds. In English there are 24 consonant and 20 vowel phonemes.

The Syllable Structure

A Syllable is one of the units into which a word may be divided. Usually it consists of a vowel sound with a consonant before or after it, but in English a syllable may consist of a single vowel. Example: /ɪ/

A syllable corresponds to a chest pulse or a muscle movement, pushing the air out of the lungs. Many words in English are monosyllabic i.e. consisting of one syllable. Example: /mæn/ and /sɪt/. The number of syllables in a word corresponds to the number of vowel sounds in that word.

Words can be made up of one, two, three or more syllables. They are monosyllabic, disyllabic, trisyllabic and polysyllabic.

Monosyllabic words:

1. Page /peɪdɪ/
2. School /sku:l/

Disyllabic words:

1. Paper /peɪ-pɪ/
2. Doctor /dɪ k-tɪ/

Trisyllabic words:

1. Remember /ri-mem-bɪ /
2. Camera /kæ-mɪ -rɪ /

Polysyllabic words:

1. Examination /ig-zæ-mi-neɪ-ɪn/
2. Application /æ-pli-keɪ-ɪn/

The structure of the syllable

A syllable consists of one or more speech sounds. These sounds are vowels and consonants. If a syllable consists of just one sound, it is usually a vowel as / ʌ / or / ɪ / . But sometimes a consonant may also constitute a syllable as / ɪ / .

If a syllable has more than one speech sound, one of them must be vowel. Example: in any /eni/. The nucleus of a syllable which is usually a vowel is symbolized as V(Vowel) and the marginal element which is usually a consonant is symbolized as C (Consonant).

The following therefore, are some of types of the structure of a syllable, composed of vowels and consonants.

Word	Transcription	Structure
A	/ə/	V
An	/æn/	VC
As	/æz/	VC
Can	/kæn/	CVC
Stray	/streɪ/	CCCV
Street	/stri:t/	CCVC
Strained	/streɪnd/	CCCVCC
Evaporate	/ɪvəˈpeɪrɪt/	VCCVCVC

The Word Accent

Word accent is an important feature of spoken English, as the incorrect word accentuation is one of the most frequent causes of unintelligibility to the listener.

In English a word has one or more syllables and in each syllable there is one sound, usually a vowel that is more prominent than the rest

while consonants take the marginal positions. Learners should have some practice in the division of words into syllables.

Now one must note that all the syllables in a word is not equally prominent. The syllables more important than the others are accented. The syllable accented has a small upright mark in front.

Example: /'ækIn/, /'templ/, /'dI k-tI / etc.

There will be no difficulty for the listener to understand where the accent lies if the speaker makes the accentuation quite clear. Of course practice in accentuation of English words is a must for the learner. Below are some stress patterns of the words of English consisting two or more syllables.

Accent goes with the spelling pattern. List of words which take stress on spelling pattern are given below:

-ity

capa'bility	disa'bility	mo'bility	proba'bility
suita'bility	adapta'bility	desira'bility	relia'bility
hospi'tability	punctu'ality	natio'nality	mor'ality
origi'nality	for'mality	men'tality	au'dacity
fe'licity	sim'plicity	multi'plicity	ca'lamity
ca'pacity	ti'midity	a'cidity	hu'midity
he'redity	l'dentity	magna'nimity	una'nimity
in'dignity	in'tegrity	cap'tivity	ma'ternity
mo'rdernity	ac'tivity	pros'perity	rela'tivity
sin'cerity	'trinity	af'finity	se'verity
in'finity	au'thority	ma'jority	di'vinity

-ageous

cou'rageous	out'rageous	disadvan'tageous
-------------	-------------	------------------

-arian

gram'marian	li'brarian	vege'tarian
humani'tarian	parliament'tarian	cante'narian

-astic

'drastic

scho'lastic

'plastic

e'lastic

fan'tastic

enthusi'astic

-ia

'media

a'media

e'lastic

intelli'gent**-ion**

'action

com'pletion

do'nation

im'mersion

contra'diction

malnu'trition

'caution

cre'ation

oc'casion

ex'pansion

exhi'bition

popu'lation

'champion

dic'tation

im'mersion

agi'tation

inter'ruption

antici'pation

-ade

bri'gade

per'suade

dis'suade

cru'sade

in'vade

lemon'nade

e'vade

pa'rade

-ial

'labial

com'mercial

'martial

fi'nancial

ad'verbial

in'dustrial

-age

'bondage

'manage

'cabbage

-ician

le'gician

mu'sician

op'tician

-istic

ar'tistic

rea'listic

sty'listic

-ese

chi'nese

japa'nese

maga'nese

-orial

mem'orial

pic'torial

tut'orial

-ience

'audience

'patience

con'venience

-sive

'massive

'passive

ag'gressive

ex'pansive

con'clusive

de'fensive

ex'plosive

of'fensive

in'tensive

-ent

'ancient

'gradient

de'ficient

ef'ficient

pro'ficient

re'cipient

-itive

'fugitive

'genitive

'positive

'primitive

'sensitive

in'finite

-oon

bal'loon

buf'foon

sa'loon

-eous

'courteous

cou'rageous

dis'courteous

out'rageous

advan'tageous

homo'genous

simul'taneous

-ious

'cautions

'anxious

'curious

am'bitious

de'licious

fer'ocious

in'dustrious

me'lodious

re'ligious

vic'torious

cere'monious

expe'ditious

-tive

'active

'captive

at'tentive

at'tractive

cor'rective

e'lective

ex'haustive

in'centive

pre'ventive

re'ceptive

re'tentive

se'lective

sug'gestive

intro'spective

irres'pective

Rhythm and Intonation

Connected speech in English has its own patterns of accentuation. Generally words that are used as nouns, adjectives, main verbs, prepositions and conjunctions are not stressed. Also, the stressed or accented syllables which are pronounced with greater force than the other syllables form a succession of beats that come at regular intervals of time available between the two accented syllables. Also, the unaccented syllables in succession are said quickly to fit into the time available.

In a stressed group, the stressed syllable may have one or more unstressed syllables before as also after the stressed syllable. Example- of unstressed syllables occurring before the stressed one.

Examples:

/æt ð 'dɪ:/ At the door

/its 'klɪ udi/ It's cloudy

Examples of unstressed syllables before the stressed one are:

/'teɪk it ðeɪ / Take it there

/'sɪ m hɪ u/ Some how

The unstressed syllables before the stressed one are said very quickly and so they are as short as you can make them. There is a great difference of length between the unstressed syllables and the stressed one. But the unstressed syllables after the stressed one are not said specially quickly. They rather share the amount of time with the single stressed syllable as in the following examples:

'Nine 'ninety 'ninetieth

Each of the three is stressed group so, /nain/ will take as much time as /naɪnti/ and /naɪntieθ/ will be quicker than /naɪnti/ and /naɪn/. Rhythm deals with the flow of the language.

Weak Forms

Words are accented and used in isolation forms are used. When not accented and used in connected speech their weak forms are used. Weak forms exhibit reduction of the length of sounds resulting in weakening of the vowels in them.

Articles	Strong form	Weak form
A	/ei/	/I/
An	/æn/	/I n/
The	/ði:/	/ði/ before a vowel /ðI/ before a consonant

Auxiliaries

Am	/æm/	/m/, /I m/
Are	/ɑ:/	/I/
Can	/kæn/	/kI n/
Does	/dIz/	/dIz/
Have	/hæv/	/hI v/
Has	/hæz/	/hI z/, /I z/
Had	/hæd/	/hI d/, /I d/
Shall	/Iæl/	/II l/ /I l/
Will	/wil/	/il/
Would	/wud/	/I d/ /d/
Must	/mIst/	/mI s/
Is	/iz/	/z/, /s/
Was	/wIz/	/wI z/
Were	/wI:/	/wI/

Prepositions

For	/fI:/	/fI/
From	/frI:m/	/frI m/
Of	/I v/	/I v/
At	/æt/	/I t/
To	/tu:/	/tI/ before a consonant /tu/ before a vowel

Conjunctions

And	/ænd/	/I nd/, /I n/
As	/æz/	/I z/
But	/bIt/	/bI t/
Than	/ðæn/	/ðI n/

Contracted Forms

In connected speech, auxiliary verbs and negations are normally contracted, contraction are of two kinds:

1. **Auxiliary + Negation**
 does+not doesn't
 has+not hasn't
 was+not wasn't
 can+ not cann't
2. **Pronoun + Auxiliary**
 she+ will she'll
 he+ is he's
 they+ will they'll
 they+ are they're

Intonation

Intonation means the changing pitch of voice for a musical arrangement of the tone. Intonation is mostly controlled by stresses because important changes of the pitch occur only on stressed syllables. Practically any phrase or sentence can be spoken in a number of ways, each carrying a different meaning.

Broadly speaking we can classify all English intonation pattern under two types- the falling tune and rising tune. Both these types normally begin with the first stressed syllable fairly high and fall stepwise from stress until the last significant stress is reached. In type one the last syllable has falling tune when the last stressed syllable remains low for any further unstressed syllables while type two. The last syllable rises from a low tone containing the rise of any further unstressed syllable.

The intonations are complex because they fulfil various functions in the same sentence. Intonations bring out attitudinal meaning which can be understood in the context of a situation and speaker's personality.

Four major intonation patterns namely:

1. Fall:


It's ten O' clock


She was here last week, wasn't she?


What's your name?


What a wonderful thought!

'Wh' questions, statements, question tags and exclamatory sentences are uttered with a falling intonation.

2. Rising:


I can't be late
(Statement intended to be encouraging)


You like it?
(Statement intended to be a question)


Have you been there?
(Non-Wh question)


Good morning
(Greetings)


Have you?
(Repetitive question)

3. Fall-rise:


Shut the window
(Command that sounds like pleading or more a request than an order)


You'll be late
(Statement which is a warning)


I went to Mumbai on Monday
(Statement consisting of two parts, the first being more important than the second)



He is forty five or forty six

(Statement which is correction of something said already)



He is generous

(Statement that show reservation on the part of the speaker)



Well, okay

(Approval)

4. Rise-fall:



I didn't hurt you, so why do you make all the fuss

(Statement that sounds as a grumble)



When did I go?

(Repetitive questions)

Come over here? Will you?

(Question tag after command)



Oh! Really

(Exclamation that are questions)



You are coming to tea with us?

(Asking the listener's opinion without expecting him agree)

A Course in English Pronunciation

Pronunciation
Unit 1
Target Sound: voiceless /p/
Spelling: p
Received Pronunciation RP Symbol: /p/
Category: Consonant Manner Stop Consonant/Plosive (Unvoiced)

Word Examples		
Initial	Medial	Terminal
Powerful	Opera	Cup
Perspective	Captivity	Stoop
Park	Camps	Shop
Problems	Discipline	Ketchup
People	Repeating	Up
Plan	Happens	Cap
Public	Topics	Top
Politicians	Experience	Sweep
Personal	Apple	Soap
Please	Typical	Pop
Paper	Workplace	Press
Airplanes	Pop	Empower
Pipe	Shopping	Position
Sleeping	Professional	Important
Position	Prevent	Preserve
Payment	Protect	

Phrases	
1.	He went upstairs panting .
2.	The plan was put before the executive committee.
3.	She wore a cap .
4.	Pre -monsoon showers
5.	The pod of gold.
Reading Passage	
Whenever people threw a birthday party and wanted a puppet show, they would call Penni. Penni was the best puppeteer in the town. She had more puppets than pepperoni on a pizza. She always had the funniest names and parts for her puppets too. One puppet was named Teepee. Teepee was a cleaner, except he only cleaned with toothpaste. Another puppet's name was Pepper. Pepper was lazy and he would only wear clothes that were made of tape. I thought Pepper was the funniest puppet because he always got stuck on things from his tape clothes. Yep, you never knew exactly what kind of puppet show to expect when Penni came to your party. But today Penni was sad. We passed her in the park and asked her what was wrong. "I can't find Pepper," she said, "I've looked for him everywhere. When I got home I opened my puppet box and I couldn't find him." "We will help you find him," my friend and I said. We called up some other people and started searching for Pepper.	
Contrast Drills	
NA	

Pronunciation
Unit 2Unit
Target Sound: voiceless /t/
Spelling: t
RP Symbol: /t/
Category: Consonant → Manner → Stop Consonant/Plosive (Voiceless)

Word Examples		
Initial	Medial	Terminal
Initial	Medial	Terminal
Table	button	Cat
Take	Guitar	Fruit
Talk	Kitten	Goat
Tally	Mittens	Hat
Tar	Potato	Coat
Tare	Eighteen	Light
Target	Rotten	Nut
Turn	Hotel	Chocolate
Torch	Cotton	Eat
Teach	Beauty	Bite
Technology	Better	Cut
Terminal	City	Cute
Term	Butter	Feet
Teacher	Little	Get
Tea	Butterfly	Sit
Tear	Tomato	Right
Telecom	Biting	Late
Top	Saturday	Hot
Tooth	water	Wet
Tour		
Town		

Phrases and Sentences

1. Dining **table**
2. Crunchy **taco**
3. **Tall** building
4. Classroom **teacher**
5. Soccer **team**
6. Pretty **teeth**
7. **Tennis** ball
8. Big **tiger**
9. So **tired**
10. Soft **tissue**
11. That building is so **tall**.
12. **Tennis** is her favourite sport.
13. We saw a **tiger** in the zoo.
14. He **tired** from working hard.
15. The **daughter** loves her mother.

Reading Passage

Growing up in **Texas** can be hot in the summertime. Our family likes to get milkshakes **to** cool off. **Tonight** our family is going to get **Texas toast, tacos, and milkshake's at "Terry's Taco House"**.

My dad came home from work last night and said he was craving a **taco** from **Terry's**. It is the **most terrific taco** place in **town**.

Everyone will get a **taco** except for my sister **Tia**, she will probably get a hamburger. Don't get me wrong, **Terry's** makes good hamburgers, but their **tacos taste** much **better** in my opinion. **Tia** just isn't a big **taco** fan.

Contrast Drills

NA

Pronunciation Mouth Yoga1**Unit 3**

Target Sound: voiceless /k/

Spelling: t

RP Symbol: /t/

Category: Consonant → Manner → Stop Consonant/Plosive (Voiceless)

Word Examples

Initial	Medial	Terminal
Can	Breakfast	Duck
Cat	Baking	Bike
Key	Chicken	Lock
Comb	Donkey	Cheek
Catch	Soccer	Hawk
Coin	Vacation	Leak
Cub	Biking	Rake
Cone	Turkey	Rock
Carrot	Cooking	Shake
Corn	Weekend	Music
Cold	Uncle	Book
Cool	Bacon	Back
Cop	Jacket	Pack
Cake	Pocket	Cook
Car	Raincoat	Sick
Kid	Looking	Check
Cave	Apricot	Book
Cot	Vacuum	Stick
Cow		Truck
Candy		
Cut		
Card		

Phrases and Sentences

1. Healthy **cabbage**
2. Wood **cabin**
3. **Cactus** in a pot
4. Chocolate **cake**
5. Soda **can**
6. Bright **candle**
7. Piece of **candy**
8. Fast **car**
9. Play **cards**
10. Nice **cat**
11. Her **cabin** is made from logs.
12. The soda was in a **cooler**.
13. The **candle** lit up the dark room.
14. The **car** is fast.
15. We will play a game with **cards**.

Reading Passage

Kati's Candy

Kati is **careful** with her **candy**. She loves it. She doesn't like **cookies, crackers, or cupcakes** - just **candy**. She likes her **candy** so much, she puts a lock on her **candy** box whenever she goes to sleep. She wears the key around her neck.

All of that changed after **Kati** got a sick stomach from eating too much **candy**. Now she eats healthy food like **carrots, corn, and turkey**. She hopes she won't get sick like that again.

Contrast Drills

NA

Pronunciation Mouth Yoga1

Unit 4

Target Sound: voiced /b/

Spelling: b

RP Symbol: /b/

Category: Consonant → Manner → Stop consonant/Plosive (Voiced)

Word Examples

Initial	Medial	Terminal
Bug	Robot	Crab
Both	Baby	Cub
Ball	Strawberry	Web
Bed	Ladybug	Crib
Bee	Cabin	Ice cube
Berry	Neighbor	Job
Birthday	About	Club
Bath	Above	Grab
Boat	Goodbye	Lab
Bottle	Habit	Rib
Beard	Marbles	Rub
Busy	Ribbon	Sob
Butter	Rabbit	Tube
Button	Mailbox	Scrub
Boy	Grabbing	Swab
Bus	Alphabet	Cab
Banana	Remember	
Bird		
Bike		
Bat		
Bag		
Bone		

Phrases and Sentences

1. Dribble the **ball**
2. Red **balloon**
3. Hanging **bat**
4. **Baked beans**
5. Hungry **bear**
6. Comfy **bed**
7. Worker **bee**
8. **Bike** ride
9. **Bird** food
10. New **boat**
11. That is a cute **baby**.
12. The **balloon** popped.
13. The **bee** works to make honeycomb.
14. This is favourite **book**.
15. He ran to catch the **bus**.

Reading Passage

I Love Bacon

Ambi walked through her neighborhood to the bus station. After sitting down she looked around. A man with a **beard** was sitting across the aisle from her. He was eating a **blueberry** muffin, a biscuit, and 4 slices of **bacon**. He **began** talking to her.

"This is the **best** kind of **bacon** you can buy," he said. "I love bacon..." he continued, "it's kind of a hobby of mine."

"That's very interesting," said Ambi. She remembered visiting their family cabin in Alabama, last October, for her **birthday**. Her family had always eaten **bacon** for **breakfast** in the mornings.

"Well, be sure that your **hobby** doesn't **become** a habit," she said, as she and the man with the **beard** laughed..

Contrast Drills

NA

Pronunciation Mouth Yoga1

Unit 5

Target Sound: voiced/d/

Spelling: d

RP Symbol: /d/

Category: Consonant → Manner → Stop Consonant/Plosive (Voiced)

Word Examples

Initial	Medial	Terminal
Dark	Medicine	Food
Day	Ladder	Hand
Dime	Radio	Mud
Do	Reading	Bed
Done	Wedding	Sand
Dust	Lady	Add
Dot	Spider	Bad
Dive	Feeding	Bread
Dance	Body	Did
Desk	Birthday	Cried
Dish	Calendar	Glad
Dog	Idea	Grade
Doll	Ready	Good
Duck	Shadow	Hide
Dentist	Tuesday	Kid
Doctor	Speeding	Loud
Dinner	Hiding	Wood
Down	louder	Sad
Dig		Red
Dove		Played
Dear		Side
Does		

Phrases and Sentences

1. **Doctor** office
2. Fun **dog**
3. Rag **doll**
4. **Dust** and clean
5. Front **door**
6. Broken **doorbell**
7. Warm **doughnuts**
8. White **dove**
9. Step **down**
10. Brown **duck**
11. We came to a **dead** end.
12. The **doctor** will prescribe some medicine.

Reading Passage

Dangerous Driver

We were riding **down** the road in our car when suddenly another car went speeding past us.

My friend **Dave** was **driving** and he got **mad**. His face turned red and he said, "That is really **dangerous**!"

The road came to a **dead end** and the car turned around. **Dave** waved his hand to stop the car. He rolled **down** his window and said, "Your speeding is **dangerous** to you and me. Please **don't do** it!"

The man in the other car apologized and said he would slow **down** in the future.

Best Pets Ever

My sister **Dana** has a **dog** named **Daisy**. I have a duck named **Doug**. They both do silly things. **Daisy** likes to **dive** into the swimming pool. **Doug** likes to **dance** to loud music. We like to take them both riding in our red wagon. They are the best pets a kid could have.

Contrast Drills

NA

Pronunciation Mouth Yoga1**Unit 6**

Target Sound: voiced /g/

Spelling: g

RP Symbol: /g/

Category: Consonant → Manner→ Stop Consonant/Plosive (Voiced)

Word Examples

Initial	Medial	Terminal
God	Luggage	Bug
Gate	Tiger	Dog
Gas	Eagle	Leg
Go	Angle	Mug
Gulp	Again	Big
Good	Wagon	Rag
Gone	Sugar	Doug
Guess	Dugout	Fog
Give	Foggy	Twig
Ghost	Magnet	Slug
Guitar	Burger	Fig
Garbage	Jogging	Dig
Goodbye	Magazine	Log
Goat	Yoga	Hug
Game	Alligator	Flag
Gum	August	Wig
Girl	Bigger	Jug
Goal		Log
Gold		
Gallon		
Garage		
Golf		

Phrases and Sentences

1. Cute **girl**
2. **Go** sign
3. **Goal** post
4. Baby **goat**
5. **Gold** pieces
6. Pet **goldfish**
7. **Golf** course
8. Pretty **goose**
9. Play **guitar**
10. Blue **gum**
11. Take the **garbage** out today.
12. The **gate** was shut.
13. He is bringing a **gift**.
14. He ready to **go**.
15. I play **guitar**.

Reading Passage

Golf Time

Each year **Gary** would play **golf** in August. He would **get** his **golf** clubs from the **garage** and drive to the **golf** course.

On his way, he would pass Farmer **Gil's** **goose** and pig farm. When he **got** to the **golf** course he bought a hot **dog**, a **bag** of chips, and a big mug of hot chocolate.

He played his best **game** while chewing sugar free **gum** and using the mug with the **green** dragon on it. He wanted to do that **again**. He **grabbed** his **golf** bag and dragon mug and headed for the first hole.

Man with the Gold Guitar

When **Gabe** began learning to play the **guitar**, he thought it would be easier than chewing **gum**. After his third lesson, his head was foggy from everything he learned. Then he met the man with the **gold guitar**.

He said his name was "**Golden**" but **Gabe** thought it was something else.

Golden taught **Gabe** to set **goals** while he learned how to play the **guitar**. **Golden** gave **Gabe** a small flag with the words “Set **Goals**” on it that he could keep with him as a reminder. **Gabe** kept it with his **guitar** and used it every time he learned a new lesson. After that, he never saw **Golden** again. Some people say **Golden** was a nice **ghost** who liked to help people.

Contrast Drills

NA

Pronunciation Mouth Yoga1

Unit 7

Target Sound: voiced “n”

Spelling: n

RP Symbol: /n/

Category: Consonant → Manner → nazal (Voiced)

Word Examples

Initial	Medial	Terminal
Knees	Sunglass	Brain
Nap	Peanut	Brown
Nest	Rainbow	Can
Knit	Banana	Cane
Nurse	Canoe	Chain
Knife	Pony	Chin
Knock	Dinner	Clean
Know	Many	Clown
Nail	Any	Done
Name	Honour	Fun
Near	Planet	Gone
Neck	Rainy	Green
New	Running	Lawn
Night	Spinning	Man
Nine	Manner	Moon
No	Frowning	Phone
Noise	Another	Run
North	Animal	Sun
Note	Canary	Train

Phrases and Sentences

1. Pointy **needle**
2. **Next** door **neighbor**
3. Bird **nest**
4. **New** shoes
5. One **nickel**
6. Dark **night**
7. **Number nine**
8. Small **nose**
9. Sticky **note**
10. Kind **nurse**
11. She is taking a **nap**.
12. There are eggs in the **nest**.
13. It is a cloudy **night**.
14. He wrote on the **napkin**.
15. She had her **neighbor** over for tea.

Reading Passage

Danny's Job

Danny didn't know what he wanted to do for a job. He was interested in so many things that it was hard to choose just one.

His friend's dad was a fireman. He ran into buildings to save people. That sounded fun, but scary. His brother was a nurse. He thought it sounded cool to help people get better when they were sick.

His mom was a money manager at a bank.

"I could make a good banker, I am good at math," Danny thought.

His dad flew an airplane. Traveling sounded exciting. To fly like the wind and see oceans and mountains. He would see the moon at night and the sun by day.

He went to a circus once. "Maybe I should become a lion tamer,"

he thought. He didn't want to smell like lion breath all day though. He went to his mom and said, "Mom what job should I do when I grow up?"

His mom said, "Danny, you're only nine. You have a few years to figure it out. In the meantime, think about what you would like to do and start learning more about it."

"Ok, thanks mom," said Danny, and he grabbed some books and began to read.

Contrast Drills

NA

Pronunciation Mouth Yoga1
Unit 8
Target Sound: voiced “m”
Spelling: m
RP Symbol: /m/
Category: Consonant → Manner → nazal (Voiced)

Word Examples		
Initial	Medial	Terminal
Man	Human	Clam
Mark	Lemon	Cream
Manner	Woman	Dream
Manage	Family	Flame
Manager	Camera	Game
Mould	Plumber	Gym
Mourn	Tomato	Ham
Member	Hamburger	Home
March	Submarine	Lamb
Monsoon	Chimney	Name
Mason	Numbers	Palm
Money	Animal	Plumb
Moral	Timer	Room
Membrane	Argument	Scream
Marshal	Image	Slim
Mathematics	Famous	Swim
Metal	Tournament	Team

Phrases and Sentences

1. Paper **money**
2. Hairy **monkey**
3. Bright **moon**
4. Black **moose**
5. Little **mouse**
6. Girl **mouth**
7. Funny **movie**
8. Brown **mud**
9. Brown **muffin**
10. Big **muscle**

Reading Passage

Clam Hamburgers

Mel had the perfect idea for a new restaurant. He wanted to **make** and sell clam hamburgers. If everyone loved clams as **much** as he did, his restaurant would be a success.

And that would only be the start. He would **make** clam **muffins**, clam ice cream, and clam tomato pie. He told his friend, **Michael**, about the idea. **Michael** told him he should ask some people if they would eat those types of food.

Mel started talking to everyone he met. He talked to the plumber, the **mailman**, a woman at the store, some people on the swim team, family **members**, and a drummer in the park.

He asked all of them if they would pay **money** for a delicious clam hamburger. All of them said, "No."

Mel couldn't believe it.

"Doesn't everyone love clams as **much** as me?" he thought.

Later that day **Mel** talked to his **mom**. She told him not to give up on his dream and that the right idea would come to him. **Mel** thanked his **mom** and followed her advice.

The next day he had **more** ideas and started **making** plans to work on them.

Contrast Drills

NA

Pronunciation Mouth Yoga1
Unit 9
Target Sound: voiced “ŋ”
Spelling: ing, ng
RP Symbol: / ŋ /
Category: Consonant → Manner → nazal (Voiced)

Word Examples		
Initial	Medial	Terminal
	Anger	Playing/pleiK/
	Anguish	Going
	Banging	Seeing
	England	Working
	English	King
	Finger	Writing
	Hanger	Reading
	Hunger	Listening
	Longer	Hearing
	Mongoose	Watching
	Singer	Speaking
	Stronger	Driving
	Younger	Riding
		Eating
		Fighting
		Learning
		Preparing
		Contesting
		Reporting
		Thing
		Wing
		Sing

Phrases and Sentences

1. **Angry** face
2. Blue **chewing** gum
3. London **England**
4. Big **finger**
5. Long **finger**nail
6. Pink **flamingo**
7. Wood **hanger**
8. Small hearing **aid**
9. **Hungry** birds
10. Gold **jingle** bell

Reading Passage

Busy Kyle

Kyle played in the school marching **band**. Tonight, the band was playing **Jingle** Bells in a nursing home for the holidays.

Next week, he would be sleeping in a snow cave at **Singer** Campground. He was going to have a busy holiday break.

Over the break he wanted to go bowling with his family, put all of his clothes on **hangers**, and practice driving. He had just received his driving permit and couldn't wait to start. He was nervous to drive on the ice.

He got **angry** when he saw others driving fast when the weather was bad. He wished he wouldn't have got his permit until the spring, but was glad he wouldn't have to wait that long. "Driving accidents happen in the spring too," he thought.

He started to get hungry. "Let's go to **King** Hot Dogs and get some dinner," he said. The marching band, **Jingle** Bells' singer, and Kyle finished their songs, hopped in their parent's van, and drove to the restaurant.

Contrast Drills

NA

Pronunciation
Unit 10
Target Sound: voiceless “θ”
Spelling: th
RP Symbol: /θ/
Category: Consonant → Manner → Fricatives/Friction Consonant (Unvoiced)

Word Examples		
Initial	Medial	Terminal
Thumb	Faithful	Breath
Thin	Method	Bath
Through	Lengthen	Faith
Thong	Youthful	Beth
Third	Mathematics	Both
Three	Enthusiasm	Oath
Thrust	Wealthy	Path
Thicken	Strengthen	Booth
Thunder	Healthy	Mouth
Thief	Athlete	North
Think	Anything	South
Thorn	Nothing	Health
Thirst	Earthquake	Length
Thursday	Something	Month
Thought	Arithmetic	Cloth
Thesis	Author	Earth
Thirsty	Birthday	Teeth
Thirteen	Toothpaste	Truth
Theory	Toothbrush	Myth
Throat	Toothache	Filth
Threw	Bathtub	Birth
Through	Ethics	Mirth

Phrases and Sentences

1. Thank you very much.
2. I **think** I will come.
3. Let's go **south**.
4. Tell the **truth**.
5. **Birthday** present.
6. **Something** to eat.
7. Take a **bath** in the **bath**tub.
8. Brush your **teeth** with a **tooth**brush and **tooth**paste.
9. **Think** of **things** to do on **Thursday**.
10. I made a **birth**day cake for her **third birth**day.
11. We flew to the **warmth** of the **south**.
12. **Thanksgiving** falls on the **third** day of the month.
13. I will not give in to your **ruth**less **threat**.
14. My dentist removed the **tooth** which gave me a mammoth **tooth**ache.
15. **Ruth** and **Thelma** **strengthened** their friendship **through** working on **mathematics**.
16. "Tell the **truth**, the whole **truth** and **nothing** but the **truth**."

Reading Passage

"Babe **Ruth** was a famous American **athlete**. He was considered to be the best baseball player of all time, and even the greatest **athlete** of all time, famous for setting baseball records. He hit seven hundred and **thirteen** home runs, and "struck out" **thirteen** hundred and **thirty** batters. Although he was often **thoughtful** and unhappy in his personal life, he **thrilled** **thousand** of fans the world over."

Contrast Drills

NA

Pronunciation

Unit 11

Target Sound: voiced “th”

Spelling: th

RP Symbol: /ð/

Category: Consonant → Manner → Fricatives/Fricative Consonant (Voiced)

Word Examples

Initial	Medial	Terminal
The	Either	With*
This	Neither	Smooth
Then	Leather	Bathe
Them	Mother	Breathe
That	Father	Soothe
They	Brother	Loath
These	Bother	Writhe
Those	Rather	Lathe
There	Lather	Blithe
Though	Further	Sheathe

* “with” can be pronounced with both a voiced and voiceless “th” sound. The voiced version is the more common.

Phrases and Sentences

1. This is **the** house
2. Don't **bother** your **brother**.
3. My **father** and **mother** are here.
4. I love good **weather**.
5. **The** book is on **the** shelf in **the** corner.
6. Go **this** way, not **that** way.
7. Come **with** me.
8. **They're** here.
9. Birds of a **feather** flock **together**.
10. There **they** are.

Reading Passage

NA

Contrast Drills /θ/ & /ɪ/

1. I **gather** your **brother's** **birth**day is on **the third** day of **the** month.
2. Take a **bath** in **the bath**tub.
3. "Tell **the truth**, **the whole truth**, and **nothing** but **the truth**" is an **oath** you must swear in court.
4. **Leather** is being replaced by cotton for **cloth**ing.
5. I'd **rather** get **together with** you on **Thursday the third**.
6. You can feel **health**y in poor **weather** by listening to **the** **sooth**ing **rhyth**ms of music.
7. She **gath**ered **heath**er on **the path** before it **wither**ed in **the** field.
8. My **grandmother** and **grandfather** are coming for **Thanksgiving** Day.
9. **Either** of **these theories** applies.
10. "**Rather than** love, **than** money, **than** fame, give me **truth**" – H.D. **Thoreau**.

Pronunciation
Unit 12
Target Sound: voiceless /f/
Spelling: f
RP Symbol: /f/
Category: Consonant → Manner → fricative/Friction Consonant (Voiceless)

Word Examples		
Initial	Medial	Terminal
Fabric	Waffle	Calf
Face	Laughing	Cuff
Fear	Office	Cough
Feat	Headphones	Chief
Fiber	Infant	Elf
Fiat	Gopher	Loaf
Fracture	Dolphin	Leaf
Fragile	Coffee	Roof
Fragmentation	Breakfast	Thief
Fragrance	Alphabet	Laugh
Fuel	Muffin	Wolf
Full	Sofa	Safe
Focus	Lifeguard	Chef
Foe	Traffic	Knife
Fetal	Trophy	Hoof
Flag	Barefoot	Wife
Flair	Playful	Golf
Flake	unfold	Half

Phrases and Sentences

1. fall season
2. quiet fan
3. old farm
4. fast horse
5. bird feather
6. white fence
7. big finger
8. hot fire
9. small fish
10. strong fist
11. The leaves turn orange and yellow in the fall.
12. The fan cools the air in the room.
13. Every summer he visited his grandparents on the farm.
14. You can tell that the horse is fast.
15. The feather is light.

Reading Passage

Zoo Fire

There was a fire at the zoo last week. All of the animals lived, but an elephant, giraffe, buffalo, and fox got out through a burnt fence.

The sheriff and the fire chief have their staff looking for them right now. They hope the animals didn't run into the forest or fall off a cliff.

They heard the animals like the smell of coffee, breakfast, waffles, and muffins, and may try to find the animals using these four things. They want to find the animals fast.

Football Team

I have played football for five years now. This fall season is the first time we have come close to winning a trophy. They will give us the trophy if we win the next four games.

Our **f**ootball team has started to practice for a **h**alf an hour each day, **f**ive days per week. We eat a big, healthy **b**reak**f**ast and in our time **o**ff we learn **f**ootball plays

One day I thought I was coming down with a cough, but it went away. I was happy it went away so **f**ast because I want to play in our games.

Contrast Drills

NA

Pronunciation
Unit 13
Target Sound: “ v ”
Spelling: v, f (esp. “of”)
RP Symbol: / v /
Category: Consonant → Manner → Fricatives (Voiced)

Word Examples		
Initial	Medial	Terminal
Very	Even	Of
Vest	Oven	Love
Vary	Movie	Live
Veto	Eleven	Leave
Visit	Invoice	Twelve
Vacuum	Silver	Move
Valuable	Seven	Drive
Vacant	Cover	Carve
Vent	Heavy	Dove
Vase	Avoid	Have
Valley	Invest	Stove
Venture	Divorce	Brave
Valve	Never	Hive
Value	River	Dive
Vic	Clever	Thrive
Vain	Invite	Arrive
Vote	Invalid	Revive
Voice	Divide	Survive

Phrases and Sentences

1. **V**ery good.
 2. **M**ove over, **R**over.
 3. **D**rive carefully.
 4. **T**welve **v**alleys.
 5. The **T**V show is on at **s**even.
 6. **E**leven piles of **l**eaves.
 7. We're **i**nvited to **v**isit in **N**ovember.
 8. **V**enture capital.
 9. We **s**aved the **l**eaves for a bonfire.
 10. The marble **v**ase is wet.
 11. The **v**alleys are beautiful.
 12. **S**teve will be **s**even in **N**ovember.
 13. We **i**nvide you to **i**nvest.
 14. **V**acuum the **l**iving room with the **v**acuum cleaner.
 15. **E**veryone must **l**eave at **f**ive o'clock.
 16. **E**ve and **V**ictor are "in **l**ove".
 17. We **h**ave **s**everal **s**avings accounts.
- The **m**ovie got **r**ave **r**eviews.

Reading Passage

"**E**ve, **V**ictor, **S**teve and **V**icky are putting **s**everal thousand dollars into a joint **v**enture. This will enable their joint **v**enture to **h**ave **v**enture capital, to **i**nvest in **v**ery good **l**iver stocks, **e**ven though they **n**ever eat **l**iver."

Learning Violin

Learning to play the **v**iolin takes many years of lessons and practice. **V**icki had just started playing and was at a beginner's **l**evel. On **V**alentine's Day, she had heard the most beautiful **v**iolin solo. She saw a couple **h**aving dinner by the **r**iver. They were staring into each other's eyes and she could tell they were in **l**ove.

When the man started playing the **violin** for the couple, something happened inside **Vicki**. She thought the **violin** sounded so beautiful that she wanted to learn how to play it. The trouble was, she really liked playing **video games**. **Video games** are much more fun to play than practicing the **violin**. **Vicki** didn't think about that when she asked her mom if she could take **violin** lessons.

At first, **Vicki** dove right in. She practiced five nights a week. She had **visions** of herself playing the **violin** for the governor or on a boat in **Venice** for a couple in love. However, as **Vicki** improved her skills, the music she played became more advanced. She would have to practice longer and think harder about the music she was playing. Playing **video games** was much easier than thinking hard about playing her **violin** every day.

One day, **Vicki** gave the **violin** to her mom.

"I don't want to play the **violin** anymore, it's too hard," she said. But **Vicki's** mom didn't want her quit. She knew playing the **violin** would be a **valuable** skill that **Vicki** could have for the rest of her life. **Vicki's** mom visited her during lunch at school the next day.

"If playing the **violin** was easy then everyone would do it," her mom said. "Remember the **vision** you had for yourself about playing the **violin** professionally?" she asked.

"Yes." said **Vicki**.

"I don't expect you to become a master **violinist**, unless you want to be. But there is a lot of **value** in knowing how to play an instrument and you will receive more of a personal **victory** by continuing and not quitting. Please don't stop," she said.

Vicki thought about it the rest of the day. That night when her mom was putting the **vacuum** away, **Vicki** told her she would not quit playing the **violin**. Her mom knew what she could achieve and was happy with **Vicki's** decision.

Contrast Drills

NA

Pronunciation
Unit 14
Target Sound: voiced “w”
Spelling: w, wh, u, qu = /kw/, o (as in “one”)
RP Symbol: /w/
Category: Consonant → Manner → Glides (Voiced)

Word Examples		
Initial	Medial	Terminal
We	Await	Whale
War	Anyway	Whir
Wax	Aware	Where
Wear	Away	When
Week	Award	What
Work	Between	Which
Wise	Unwilling	White
Walk	Beware	Wheel
Welcome	Unwell	While
Want	Swivel	Anywhere
Wag	Twist	Nowhere
Weep	Twirl	Worthwhile
Wind	Twice	
Word	Twiddle	
Wool	Twig	
Woods	Twin	
Weary	Twilight	
Waiter	Twine	
West	Twinkle	
Way	Twinge	
Won	Awake	
Worry	Bewitch	
Wash		
Waste		
Wednesday		
Wonderful		

Phrases and Sentences

1. **Where** do you **work**?
2. A long **way**.
3. **We** are going **away**.
4. I **walk** quickly.
5. **One** plus **one** is two.
6. **Waste** not, **want** not!
7. **Where** is it, **anyone**?
8. **Wise** and **wonderful**.
9. **What** do you **want**?
10. **Weep** for the victims of **war**.
11. The **wedding** party **was** **wearing** **white**.
12. The **Queen** quickly gave the **award**.
13. **Where**, **what**, **when**, **who** and **why** are important questions.
14. **Walter**, **was** that your **question**?
15. The **choir** sang the **wonderful** song **between** scenes at the theatre.
16. **Where** did **Woodrow Wilson** live?
17. The **award** **was** given at dawn.
18. **Why** **would** one **want** another **World War**?

Reading Passage Clam Hamburgers

Have you ever **wondered** **what** **whales** are communicating to each other **when** they **swim** the vast oceans of the **world**? Many scientists believe that they have a very sophisticated “language” of their own.

One **whale**, **weaving** in and out of the **waves** of the Pacific Ocean, can call out **with** his **wailing** voice, and be heard and understood by another **whale** hundreds of miles **away**.

Their “language” consists of a variety of **wails**, **whistles**, and other sounds unlike the **vowels** and consonants of English. **Wouldn't** it

be **w**onderful if **w**e could visit the **w**hales and communicate **w**ith them the **w**orld over!

Contrast Drills

1. **V**ery **w**illing.
2. **L**ove our **w**orld.
3. **W**in me **o**ver.
4. A loving **w**ife.
5. **W**ithout **v**inegar.
6. A **w**onderful **v**iew.
7. A **w**icked **v**illain.
8. **V**ery good **w**eather.
9. **Q**uit **w**hile you're ahead.
10. **W**ise **v**alues.

Pronunciation**Unit 15**

Target Sound: voiced /l/

Spelling: L/l

RP Symbol: /l/

Category: Consonant → Manner → Lateral Consonant (Voiced)

Word Examples

Initial	Medial	Terminal
Leaf	Belly	Ball
Lamp	Sailing	Mail
Laugh	Balloon	Nail
Leak	Alarm	Seal
List	Police	Pool
Long	Salad	Muscle
Letter	Pillow	Fall
Light	Wallet	Shell
Land	Eleven	Tail
Listen	Family	Yell
Lock	Wallpaper	Tall
Love	Silly	Tool
Lemon	Pilot	Bowl
Lamb	Dollar	Bell
Leg	Island	Whale
Lips	Olive	Owl
Log	Jelly	Hill
Lunch	Shoelace	Pencil
Lazy	Elbow	Towel
Lion	Elephant	Wheel
Lake	Violin	Hole
Late	Envelope	Spell

Phrases and Sentences

1. Tall ladder
2. Pretty lady
3. Beautiful lake
4. Burning lamp
5. Open land
6. Orange leaf
7. Hanging light
8. Bright lighting
9. Pink lips
10. Shopping list
11. The lake has mountains around it.
12. They used a candle in the lamp.
13. The leaf fell from the tree.
14. Turn on the light.
15. It is a long walk on the beach.

Reading Passage

Fireworks Show

Dale jumped up when he heard his alarm. Today was the fourth of July and he couldn't wait to watch the firework show!

He found a tall hill that he could watch the show from very well. He and his family ate lunch on the hill, threw a ball around, and played silly games all day until it was time for the show.

The fireworks were bright and loud like lightning. Dale liked to look at all of the different colors that lit up the sky.

After the show was over he got a call from his uncle Larry. Uncle Larry studied leaves in Brazil and called to ask Dale about the firework show. Dale told his Uncle how great the show had been. Uncle Larry laughed and said, "That is wonderful! I wish I could have been there to celebrate with you. We'll see, maybe I can visit next year."

Contrast Drills

NA

Pronunciation**Unit 16**

Target Sound: "r"

Spelling: r, wr

RP Symbol: /r/

Category: Consonant → Manner → Liquid (Voiced)

Word Examples

Initial	Medial	Terminal
Read	Around	Are
Reach	Orange	Or
Red	Moral	Par
Rest	Marry	Far
Rail	Erase	Four
Rage	Error	Door
Rack	Borrow	
Rap	Tearing	
Rice	Bearing	
Room	Story	
Rude	Berry	
Rote	Very	
Roam	Correct	
Road	Tomorrow	
Real		
Right		
Wrong		
Rent		
Wreck		
Rush		
Rip		
Reel		
Rinse		
Wreath		
Raise		
Wrought		
Rough		
Ram		
Rig		
Writ		
Wrinkle		
Rash		
Rot		

Phrases and Sentences

1. Where are they?
2. Dear mother and father.
3. Four cars.
4. Over there, over here.
5. Thank you for dinner.
6. Correct order.
7. Corporate culture.
8. Work environment.
9. Future leader.
10. Ensure security.
11. Inspire pleasure.
12. Under the orange tree.
13. A friendly computer network shares software and hardware.
14. Ron and Rick tried word processing programs called "Word Perfect" and "Word Star".
15. Rita wrote on the board, "to rest your computer, strike the appropriate keys Alt, control, and delete all at the same time.
16. For security, Iris shreds her hard copies. Then the remains are recycled for creating new paper.
17. Harold's computer hardware consists of the keyboard, the screen or monitor, the disk drive, hard drive, lots of RAM, and of course, a printer.
18. The shop carries numerous computer options. Some examples are: color monitors, graphic cards, laser printers, CD ROM drives, larger RAM, and different varieties of software.
19. The purpose of a computer is to create letters, charts and graphs on the screen. Only then can you electronically transmit to another computer, thereby saving trees and rain forests.

Reading Passage

A corporate culture is a belief system, creed, or set of “rules” which influences people to work together in their corporate environment. Companies promote corporate culture in order to inspire team spirit and career recognition. Successful firms share their corporate culture with their customers. Understanding the corporate culture in your workplace can bring security and pleasure to your career. Leaders and corporate presidents who promote great corporate culture ensure security for their shareholders, workers and suppliers. Mary was inspired by reading about corporate culture at her accent improvement course, and wrote a creed for her corporation, ensuring her security for life. Mary's presentation to the Board of Directors was turned down. She insisted that since she was the president, and the largest shareholder, she would overrule the Board of Directors and fire them all. Her father, mother, sister and four brothers are now looking for work.

Contrast Drills

NA

Pronunciation
Unit 17
Target Sound: voiceless /j/
Spelling: y
RP Symbol: /j/
Category: Consonant → Manner → Glides (Voiced)

Word Examples		
Initial	Medial	Terminal
Yesterday	Layer	
Young	Loyal	
Yellow	Royal	
Yale	reuse	
York		
Yacht		
Yam		
Yank		
Yawn		
Yogurt		
Year		
Yawn		
Yes		
Yell		
You		
Your		
Youth		
Year		

Phrases

1. Yesterday was my birthday.
2. Yellow is my favorite color.
3. I bought a frying pan **y**esterday.
4. Rajesh is tying a knot with his **y**oung girl friend.
5. Driving makes me **y**awn.
6. **Y**es please
7. Used sho**e**
8. Lo**y**al dog
9. **N**ew York city
10. **N**ew year

Reading Passage

During their tournament in **Yellowstone** Park, the **youth** basketball team stopped to eat at a Mexican restaurant. The restaurant handmade all of their tortillas and tortilla chips. When asked if the teammates wanted a "Super Wild Burrito," the answers were a unanimous, "**Y**es please!" Only one person said they wanted teriyaki chicken.

When the teammates went to pay for their burrito, the cashier would **yell**, "Super Wild Burrito going out!" and all the other employees would **yell** back in unison, "Super Wild Burrito coming at **you**!"

It was a fun atmosphere and all of the teammates decided to make coming to the restaurant a **yearly** tradition.

After eating their burritos the team all **yawned**. They began to fall asleep on each other, using the shoulder of the person next to them as a pillow.

"We're ready for a nap," they said.

"Not until we've had dessert," one of the **younger** team mates said.

The restaurant made a delicious papaya cake that they

recommended with their burritos. The team bought enough pieces of papaya cake for everyone to share a piece. After eating the cake, the team gave the employer and employees a happy “Thank You” and promised to visit next year when they returned to play in the tournament.

Contrast Drills

NA

Pronunciation
Unit 18
Target Sound: “s”
Spelling: s, c, sc
RP Symbol: /s/
Category: Consonant → Manner → Fricatives (Unvoiced)

Word Examples		
Initial	Medial	Terminal
So	Lesson	Kiss
See	Blessing	Bus
Sit	History	Boss
Set	Pest	Yes
Sag	Last	Dress
Certain	Fast	House
Certainly	Asleep	Course
Civil	Answer	Class
Circle	Listen	Caps
Scenic	Custom	Plates
Scent	Tracing	Keeps
Science	Bracing	Cheeks
Screen	Peaceful	Fights
Screw	Tryst	Thoughts
Scratch	Whistle	Notes

Phrases and Sentences

1. Sit down.
2. Nice to meet you, Steven.
3. The stop sign is near the corner.
4. Speak for yourself.
5. He lives in a fancy society.
6. Send the basic by fax.
7. They won the race at a swift pace.
8. The weekend is on Saturday and Sunday.
9. Susan tried to stop smoking.
10. The famous boss stood on the stage.
11. She is a ballet dancer
12. The sun was starting to set.
13. The grasshopper has big legs.
14. Cactus grows in different shapes.
15. She wearing yellow dress.

Reading Passage

Southern

Railways announced a recruitment drive for the post of Signal Inspectors last week. The exams will be conducted during September last, the announcement said. Southern Railways expect more than sixty thousand candidates to appear in the exams even though the vacancy is for seventy-six openings.

Sailboat

Last December I was sad because my favorite baseball team lost in a tournament. You should have seen my face, it looked like someone erased my smile.

To cheer me up my dad took me out on our sailboat. It was a little messy so we took some soap and cleaned it up first. We took some sandwiches, soup, and juice and left the house early on Saturday morning.

We spent a few hours sailing around the lake. It was relaxing to just sit and listen to the water against the boat and soak up some sun. Dad told me he was sorry about the baseball team losing.

"They will have more chances to win in the future," he said. I told him I wasn't too sad anymore. "I just really wanted them to win," I said. Dad suggested that we sing the team song. He thought that would help us get excited for next year's tournament.

"Next year we will sit outside on the grass behind the fence to watch the game," dad said. "We can take some salad, popsicles, and your toy dinosaurs. It will be the most fun we've ever had at a baseball game." I love my dad. He is so good at helping me be happy.

Contrast Drills

NA

Pronunciation
Unit 19
Target Sound: “z”
Spelling: z, s, x
RP Symbol: /z/
Category: Consonant → Manner → Fricatives (Voiced)

Word Examples		
Initial	Medial	Terminal
Zoo	Busy	Is
Zero	Business	As
Zone	Easy	Was
Zipper	Cousin	His
Zeal	Dizzy	Hers
Zebra	Puzzle	Theirs
Zest	Razor	Eyes
Zinc	Music	Flowers
Zombie	Fizzy	Nose
Zoology	Muzzle	These
Zulu	Nozzle	Those
Zigzag		Buzz
		Amaze
		Daze
		Breeze
		Please

Phrases and Sentences

1. That suit is my size.
2. The puzzle is easy.
3. My cousin was visiting.
4. The zebra lives in the zoo.
5. His eyes looked glazed.
6. Exercise is advisable.
7. Please xerox the agenda.
8. Will he arrive on Tuesday, Wednesday or Thursday?
9. These clothes fit well.
10. The President was supposed to resign.

Reading Passage

Flowers Galore

Zach went over to Zoe's house on Thursday. She was outside with the hose. Her house had tons of flowers around it. There must have been a zillion. It was so beautiful that Zach thought she deserved a prize for the most beautiful flower garden ever!

Zoe took Zach around each of the flower beds and told him what the flowers were called. He didn't sneeze once. His favorites were the zinnias. They felt so soft on his fingers when he touched them and, besides that, zinnias were the coolest name. Any words that started with a Z like "Zach" were the coolest.

Zoe asked him if we wanted to help water the flowers. He took the hose and began watering. When he got over to the zinnias they were surrounded by bees. Zach had zero love for bees, so he dropped the hose and ran as fast as he could. He zigged and zagged, but there was still one bee zooming after him. Zach yelled, "Please, please, please don't sting me!" Just in time, Zoe zoomed in with her fly swatter and zapped that bee to the ground.

Zoe shrugged her shoulders and said, "You want to go in and have some cookies?" Zach nodded and said, "Yes please!"

Contrast Drills /s/ & /z/

1. Abuse is bad; please don't abuse anyone.
2. Please excuse me; I have a good excuse.
3. May I use that knife; if it of no use to you.
4. I live in the house, which houses my furniture.
5. My daughter will lose her loose tooth.
6. My eyes are closed when I sleep.
7. It's raining "cats and dogs."
8. To "kill two birds with one stone."
9. He surprised me with two gifts -- a pair of scissors and three hats.
10. There are many ways to make bets.
11. Come as soon as possible.
12. We won the race on Wednesday.
13. These prices are costly.
14. Can you raise the dollars and cents for a good cause?
15. May I use your house on Sunday?

Unit 20

Spelling: sh, ch, s, -tion or -sion (as in 'shun')

Category: Consonant → Manner → Fricatives (Unvoiced)

Initial

Medial

Terminal

Ship

Brush

Shall

Nation

Crush

Shoe

Station

Mash

Short

Patient

Finish

Sugar

Machine

English

Shower

Mission

Spanish

Shirt

Ration

Dish

Phrases and Sentences

1. Smart **chef**
2. **Shake** hands
3. Hair **shampoo**
4. Nice to **share**
5. **Sharp** thorn
6. Morning **shower**
7. **Shot** in arm
8. Plain **shirt**
9. Sore **shoulder**
10. Cruise **ship**
11. Are you **sure**?
12. Please, **shut** the door.
13. Let me **shake** your hand.
14. I'm a bit **short** on **cash**.
15. My **washing machine** is fixed.
16. I have six **shirts** at the cleaners.
17. We **should assure** you the **motion** was passed by the president.
18. Charles gave **Sharon** permission to go to Russia.
19. **Surely**, it is a pleasure to speak **English**!
20. A profession as a **physician** is demanding.

Reading Passage

Successful Chef

Chicago has some of the best **chefs** in the United States. **Sharon** was one of those **chefs**. **Sharon** was the head **chef** at “Flash”, a very expensive restaurant.

Like many people, **she** liked to **shop**, **wash** her car, and sip lemonade in the **shade**, but unlike many people, **she** was an accomplished **chef**. **She** had been a **chef** for over 15 years.

Growing up, **she** loved to cook. **She** experimented with different combinations of ingredients to see how they would taste.

Many people thought this was childish, but even as a young girl, **Sharon** made food **dishes** that astonished her friends and family. Her biggest secret was that **she** only used **fresh** ingredients. When it came to quality, **Sharon** never took **shortcuts**.

She had selected every ingredient and paid **special** attention to how they smelled in the store before **she** bought them. **She** was always cautious to avoid discounted ingredients because **she** knew they wouldn't taste right.

Another one of her secrets was that **she** had excellent communication and cooperation with her staff. **She** was only one person, and **she** needed people who would listen and follow her directions. **Sharon** loved what **she** did. **She** was an amazing **chef**.

Even though **she** loved working at “Flash” **she** wanted to open her own restaurant some day. **She** looked forward to the day that **she** would own her own restaurant.

Contrast Drills

NA

Unit 21

Spelling: ure

Category: Consonant → Manner → Fricative (Voiced)

[illegible]

Phrases and Sentences

1. Azure sky
2. Leisure time
3. Quick measure
4. Clear vision
5. Big garage
6. Fast luge
7. Put on rouge
8. She is taking some leisure time.
9. It was a bad collision.

Reading Passage

Jacques Photography

Jacques was born in France, but grew up in Asia. He was a massage therapist who traveled the world. One of Jacques' favorite hobbies was to make collages. Whenever he went anywhere, he took tons of pictures. After taking the pictures, he would develop them in his garage, which he turned into a photo studio, and created collages from them.

Jacques had many people who admired his photographs. There were many people who offered him money for his pictures. It is not surprising either. He specialized in capturing breath-taking colors.

Jacques had a unique talent of capturing the azure blue color of the sky. He had inspiring pictures of the sunset that displayed the most beautiful rouge hues you can imagine. He had traveled all over Asia and taken pictures of landscapes, colorful performers, and captivating city skylines at night.

Indeed he was a talented photographer. He even spent his leisure time reading about different aspects of photography in order to improve his skills.

His next plan was to travel to Persia. He had read about the history of Persia and it was fascinating to him. He knew he would be able to take beautiful photographs there.

Jacques had a vision of photography that was higher than anyone I've ever met. If you ever get the chance to meet him and see his pictures, take it. You won't be sorry!

Contrast Drills

NA

Unit 22

Spelling: **ch**

Category: Consonant → Manner → Affricates (Unvoiced)

Initial

Cheese

Child

Chair

Chicken

Chew

Chain

Chance

Chase

Medial

Kitchen

Watching

Exchange

Marching

Searching

Butcher

Pitcher

Question

Terminal

Each

Catch

Sandwich

Research

Speech

Teach

Lunch

Munch

Phrases and Sentences

1. Watch out!
2. I think I'm catching a cold.
3. I love chocolate chip cookies.
4. Which furniture did you purchase?
5. I'm searching for Charles in the kitchen.
6. Here is a cheese sandwich for lunch.
7. The teacher will teach the lesson.
8. Visit the beach.
9. Leafy tree branch.
10. Lunch time
11. I fell asleep in couch.
12. Month of March.
13. Reach up high.
14. Please light the match.
15. Wooden match.

Reading Passage

Lunch Interruption

It was time for lunch. Chip wanted to eat lunch on the beach today. He walked to the beach. There were no benches, so he sat in the sand. He opened his lunch box and found chili, cheese, a sandwich, a cherry, and some peaches.

He took a bite of his sandwich and began to chew when all of a sudden his chin started itching. He was getting sand flea bites. He grabbed his lunch and took off like a cheetah.

"I guess I'll go eat in my kitchen at home," he thought.

Day at the Zoo

Our teacher, Ms. Child, is teaching us about the ostrich. We went to the zoo to see an ostrich. We also saw a cheetah.

There was a farm animal area where we saw a **chicken**. I bought a key **chain** at the zoo, ate my **lunch** on a **bench**, and shared some of it with a **chipmunk**. It was fun to **watch** all of the animals.

Our class let out a cheer when we saw the ostrich **run**. It was fast. I wanted to feed the ostrich some **chocolate**, but the zookeeper said not to.

Hopscotch Challenge

In **March**, I took **chalk** and drew some squares to play hopscotch on. My friend **Chase** and I wanted to play together.

I drew the squares on the sidewalk close to the **church** with the **chicken statue**.

I asked **Chase** to watch and check if the squares were in the right order. He told me one of them was a few inches off. I told him that I moved them to miss a big tree branch.

We started playing. I pounded my **chest** after beating him three times! I would still **cheer** for him though.

Contrast Drills

NA

Unit 23

Spelling: j, g, dg, dj

RP Symbol: /dɪ/

Category: Consonant → Manner → Affricates (Voiced)

Word Examples

Initial	Medial	Terminal
Jaw	Adjust	Age
June	Imagine	Edge
Jam	Agent	Pledge
Joy	Margin	Stage
Job	Surgeon	Strange
Jog	Ranging	Orange
Jeweler	Larger	Fudge
Gym	Region	Large
Gin	Religion	Merge
Gentleman	Legion	Average

Phrases and Sentences

1. Enjoy yourself; it's later than you think!
2. He is jack of all trades.
3. When you become a citizen, you pledge allegiance to the flag.
4. I will be there, in just a second.
5. It's not good to hold a grudge.
6. John can't take a joke.
7. Don't cross the bridge until you come to it.
8. We have exceeded our budget.

Contrast Drills /I/ & /tI/ & /dZ/

1. I wish to choose a jar of jam.
2. Chocolate fudge is delicious.
3. Show me the picture on page six.
4. The future of the fashion industry is secure.
5. At a young age he made a small wage, but his riches grew when he finished learning English.

Unit 24

Spelling: h

Category: Consonant → Manner → Fricatives (Unvoiced)

[illegible]

Phrases and Sentences

1. **Hurry over here!**
2. **Who's** at the door?
3. **How** are you?
4. What **happened**?
5. **He hit** a home run.
6. We ate **hamburgers** and **hot** dogs.
7. We went to **Hawaii** on our **honeymoon**.
8. **Harry** is an honest person.
9. I **hate hot** and **humid** weather.
10. **He hurt his hand** while **hammering** in the **house**.
11. **Her hero** gave **her his heart**.
12. Your **happiness** often depends on your sense of **humor**.
13. **Perhaps he** will **inherit** a fortune.
14. **Her misfortune** is now **behind her**.
15. I will be ready in **half** an hour.
16. **Who** is at the door?
17. **How many hours have** we been **here**?

Reading Passage

Hilda and Harry left for a blissful honeymoon in Hawaii. "This is heaven," they said. "We've never been this happy." When they arrived at their honeymoon hotel, however, hoping to be alone, the manager said, "perhaps you'd like to have dinner, since your room isn't ready." "But we've just had hamburgers," said Hilda. "I'm sorry madam" the manger replied, "but the housekeeper has quit and your room is a mess." So Harry and Hilda had another dinner of hamburgers, and then asked for their room again. "I'm sorry, but Her Highness the Queen has arrived, and I had to give her your room." "That's horrible," said Harry, and he was so angry he slipped, broke his hip, and had to be taken to the hospital. There, he and Hilda were given a private room and a special dinner of hamburgers, on the house. They were alone at last!

Contrast Drills

NA

Pronunciation
Unit 25
Target Sound: “ I ” (short “i”)
Spelling: i, y
RP Symbol: /I/
Category: Vowel → Monophthongs → Front

Word Examples		
Initial	Medial	Terminal
If	Lift	
Is	Fit	
It	Six	
In	Did	
It's	Kiss	
Itch	Fits	
Into	Hit	
Ink	Lip	
Intend	Litter	
Imply	Simple	
Illegible	Tim	
Inches	Minute	
Issue	List	
Imitate	Build	
Inner	Mystery	
Idiot	Pity	
Inmate	This	
Inane	Bring	
Insane	Which	
Improve	Fifty	
	Kitchen	
	Little	
	Finish	

Phrases and Sentences

1. What is it?
2. This is it.
3. I missed it.
4. This is a big city.
5. It's a pity.

Reading Passage

Sea is a large body of saltwater surrounded in whole or in parts by land. Sea is the interconnected system of Earth's salty oceanic waters, considered as on global ocean or as several principles oceanic divisions.

Seas and oceans occupy most of the Earth's surfaces and it plays a very important role to support life. Sea moderates Earth's climate and has important roles in the water cycle, carbon cycle and nitrogen cycle.

Our Earth is basically covered with seas and oceans at its Southern Hemisphere. The Northern Hemisphere have almost comparable portion of land and water.

There is a difference of temperature and salinity at different portions of the sea such as at different depths and different areas. These differences produce deep sea currents. Also surface currents are formed by friction of waves produced by the wind and by tides, changes in the local sea level produced by gravity of The Moon and the Sun.

Sea is a storehouse of treasure in the form of uncountable life forms of which a lot more are yet to be discovered. Also it is a storehouse of minerals. Sea is a very mysterious place and due to its vast nature it always drives human beings curious about it.

The nature of sea is different at different places because of various geographical features surrounding it. At some places the salinity is so high that human beings do not drown in that sea. And of course no living thing can survive. The seas and oceans are the reservoir of the most important ingredient in our food. I.e. salt

Contrast Drills

NA

Pronunciation Unit 26
Target Sound: "i:"
Spelling: e, ea, ee,
RP Symbol: /i:/
Category: Vowel → Monophthongs → Front

Spelling: e, ea, ee,

Category: Vowel → Monophthongs → Front

[illegible]

Phrases

1. See you at three o'clock.
2. Good evening.
3. I will be free next week.
4. Can you see what I mean?
5. I'm pleased to meet you.

Reading Passage

Spring comes after the winter season. It begins from the middle of February and lasts till the middle of April. As the spring season sets in, the earth looks lovely and charming. The trees put forth new leaves.

The nature looks charming and many kinds of beautiful flowers bloom during this season. The lovely roses win our hearts. When we walk in a garden, we are enchanted by the dazzling colors of flowers. As a matter of fact spring is the season of beautiful flowers. Bees are very busy during this season. They move from one flower to another in search of honey. We see the beautiful butterflies flying about. They catch the fancy of children.

The days of the spring season are very pleasant. Spring is neither hot nor cold. The temperature remains at moderate levels. It is very delightful. It is good for health.

Spring is the season of charming sounds. The bees humming in the garden fill our hearts with joy. The cuckoo is mad with joy. Its sweet notes enchant us. In the early morning we hear the birds twittering in trees.

It is delightful to walk through the corn-fields during spring. The green plants please the eyes. The yellow flowers of mustard flutter in the breeze. The earth wears a green garment. Spring transforms it into a paradise.

The spring season offers great pleasures. The cold of winter are biting. The summers are hot. Rainy season remains full of dirt and mud. It is the spring season which catches our fancy. It brings extraordinary beauties and charms.

Contrast Drills /ɪ/ & /i:/

Peter and Richard had lived in New Zealand before moving to East Africa three years ago. They enjoyed going on safaris and seeing animals like giraffes, zebras and hippos. Life was easy. Peter decided to become a gamekeeper since he was interested in animals and liked meeting people. Richard assisted him. One evening, a giraffe hurt itself and had to be taken to the hospital. The vet examined the giraffe and said that it had injured its heel. It needed treatment for a week. When the wound healed, Peter and Richard returned to the park with the healthy giraffe.

Pronunciation
Unit 27
Target Sound: “u”
Spelling: y, u, ew, ue
RP Symbol: /u/
Category: Vowel → Monophthongs → Back

Word Examples		
Initial	Medial	Terminal
You	Beauty	Cue
Use	Beautiful	Hue
You’ll	Cube	Few
You’d	Cute	Pew
	Fume	
	Fuse	
	Huge	
	Mule	
	Future	
	Viewer	
	Fuses	
	Cubist	
	Fewer	
	Fewest	
	Cutest	
	Community	
	Communication	

Phrases and Sentences

1. **You** fooled my mule.
2. **You** fuel the feud.
3. **Hugh** knew the **future** **views** of his **community**.
4. Who can see the **beautiful** **booty**?
5. The **feud** will stop when the food and booze run out.
6. **You'll** **view** the **future** in that magic **view** finder.
7. He wears **huge** **shoes**.
8. There are **fewer** mice today.

Reading Passage

'We are not concerned with the very **poor**. They are unthinkable, and only to be approached by the statistician or the poet.' Generally, or in common parlance, a '**poor**' is that person who does not have sufficient amount of money to purchase food to keep him and the members of his family alive and the necessary clothing and a shelter in the form of a house.

These are the persons who do not have a proper diet, no shelter or have depleted shelter, live in insanitary conditions, and have a lower life expectancy than the majority of population. Their house is often overcrowded.

Many of them sleep on streets, subways, **foot**paths, doorways or park benches under the open sky. In extreme winter, they sometimes freeze to death in certain areas. In **rural** areas, they live in mud thatched small huts and in urban areas in ghettos (slums), devoid of all basic utilities—water, latrines, bathrooms, electricity, etc. Thus, such persons must be defined as **poor**, no matter whether society recognizes their poverty or not.

Most **poor** people are either engaged in low-paying jobs or are without jobs. Some are too ill or disabled to work and others are living alone (aged, widowed), who cannot earn enough to support

themselves and their children, if any. The **poor** cannot get loans for self-employment.

They cannot seek employment where work is available. They also pay more for most of what they buy. Most of their incomes, if any, are spent on food. Moreover, the commodities they purchase from nearby grocery shop are often of low quality, adulterated and stale devoid of any nutritive value.

Contrast Drills

NA

Pronunciation**Unit 28**

Target Sound: “ U: “

Spelling: U, oo, ew, oe, o

RP Symbol: / u: /

Category: Vowel → Monophthong → Long

Word Examples

Initial	Medial	Terminal
Ooze	Mood	Who
Oodles	Food	Shoe
Uber	Pool	Flew
	Tool	New
	Stool	Drew
	School	Do
	Stoop	Clue
	Loop	Blew
	Troop	You
	Goose	To
	Loose	Through
	Choose	Threw
	Rude	
	Rule	
	Whose	
	Group	
	Boot	
	Root	
	Tooth	
	Booth	
	Ruth	
	Truth	

Phrases and Sentences

1. He is a **true blue** friend.
2. What's **new** with **you**?
3. Robert has a **loose tooth**.
4. How are **you**, **Ruth**?
5. I'm not in the **mood** to **argue** with **you**.
6. **Too few** people **choose** to obey rules.
7. The **rumor** spread **through** the **school room**.
8. I'll have a **tuna sandwich**, a bowl of **soup**, and some **fruit** for dessert.
9. **Ruth** is a **student** at the **University**.
10. The **beautiful tulips** are **blooming** in the garden.
11. My **new boots** were **ruined** in the rain.
12. We **used** to work in the **blue** building on **University Avenue**.
13. Tell the **truth**, the whole **truth**, and nothing but the **truth**," is an oath **you** must say in court.
14. Please **remove** your **boots** when **you** enter the **cool room**.
15. **Too few** people realize the importance of **choosing** the best **school** to **suit** their children.

Reading Passage

Educational institutions are the true seats of learning. The students, who are really anxious to learn, can develop healthy habits only in the **schools**. In a school we are taught how to move in society, how to behave with others and how to progress in life.

I studied at St. John's Higher Secondary **School** - Andaman and Chennai. With a lush garden outside, the **school** building presents a magnificent view. Its grassy lawns and gravel path with flowers along its sides and the Asoka trees growing near the gate add to its beauty. Any outsider may form the idea that it is perhaps a memorial building.

Besides the beautiful building, spacious grounds and flowered beds, there are other things which attract our particular attentions. There is a grand swimming **pool** where every facility is provided to the students to learn swimming. The **school** has its own canteen where some eatables - hot tea or coffee and cold drinks - are always avail at subsidized rates. Hygienic conditions prevail in and around the **school** canteen. Besides, there is a cycle stand where the teachers and students park their cycles and scooters. An attendant is there who looks after the vehicles. Our **school** has many firsts to its credit. It has won many trophies in inner-school debates and declamation contests.

In studies, our **school** shows goods results every year. Our **school** figures in the merit list every year. Our Principal is a great scholar. He meets some of the classes himself once a week to ensure regular teaching. Our teachers are well qualified and trained. They take pains in the teaching work. The students are well behaved and intelligent. The physical training teacher has also worked a lot for the benefit of the students.

Contrast Drills /U/ & /U:/

Prudence was a young **woman** who liked **books**. Whenever she felt **blue**, she **took** a **good book** and some **food** with her and went to the **woods** in the evening. She **would** sit in a **nook** by the **pool**. Sometimes she would spend time **looking** at the **two** goldfish swimming around. At other times she **would** put her **foot** into the **cool blue** water. When she had finished her **book**, she was **usually** in a **good mood**. She **would** wait for the **moon** to be up and then casually stroll back home.

Pronunciation
Unit 29
Target Sound: “ e “
Spelling: e, ea, ai
RP Symbol: /ɛ/
Category: Vowel → Monophthongs → Front

Word Examples		
Initial	Medial	Terminal
End	Red	
Egg	Bed	
Elephant	Led	
Enter	Met	
Exit	Pet	
Excuse	Set	
Exercise	Pen	
Else	Rent	
Every	Regulate	
Energy	Next	
	Rest	
	West	
	Fence	
	Present	
	Seven	
	Never	
	Yes	
	Telephone	
	Felt	
	Seldom	

Phrases and Sentences

1. Ted said it.
2. Buy a head of lettuce.
3. Pat is my best friend.
4. It's wonderful to be healthy and wealthy.
5. Take the elevator to the tenth floor.
6. Remember; never put the cart before the horse.
7. The secretary answered the telephone.
8. I've never felt better.
9. Wendy went to bed at seven o'clock.
10. Ted received several presents on his birthday.
11. Everyone was watching television when I left.
12. Send seventeen men to help out.
13. Can you lend me a pen for the lesson?
14. The proposal was well written, but rejected for its outrageous content.

Reading Passage

L&M is a telecom company. Ben and Kevin are engineers who are employed there. They met each other when they joined **L&M** and ever since they have been good friends. They got together every evening and enjoyed a good meal together at a restaurant where they saw Melanie. The next day, they went to a cyber café to surf the net. As they entered the café, they met Melanie again. She had come there to send an e-mail to her friend in America. After they had checked their mail, they dropped Melanie home, even though it meant taking a longer route.

Contrast Drills

NA

Pronunciation
Unit 30
Target Sound: “æ “
Spelling: a, au
RP Symbol: /æ/
Category: Vowel → Monophthongs → Front

Word Examples			
Initial	Medial	Terminal	Unusual
As	Plant		Laugh
At	Wrap		Laughter
Am	Rat		
And	Have		
Ask	Rack		
Act	Mask		
After	Map		
Angry	Sad		
Actor	Cat		
Absent	Happy		
Animal	Lap		
Atom	Flag		
Apple	Grass		
Adverse	Rapid		
Annual	Glass		
	Path		
	Black		

Phrases

1. Matt is **last**.
2. Patty wrapped it **up**.
3. Is that a **fact**?
4. Clap your **hands**.
5. That's a **rack** of lamb.
6. This is your **last** chance.
7. Give him a **pat** on the back.

Reading Passage

Ann, Fran, Jan and Jack went in a **van**, to **tackle** the man who **ran** over their **cat**. The **cat**, a **fat** ball of wool, was called **Zap**. **Zap** loved to chase **rats** and pick on **gnats**. One day **Zap** saw a **fat rat** and **ran** to **catch** it. He **ran** so **fast** that **Ann** didn't have a chance to **catch** him. **Ann** **ran** very **fast** behind **Zap** and tried to stop him. **Dan**, driving **fast**, didn't see **Zap** dart across the road and **ran** over him. **Ann**, **Fran**, **Jan** and **Jack** went to the **van** and **tackled** **Dan**.

Fax Machine

Short for *facsimile machine*, a device that can send or receive pictures and text over a telephone line. Fax machines work by digitizing an image -- dividing it into a grid of dots. Each dot is either on or off, depending on whether it is **black** or **white**. Electronically, each dot is represented by a bit that has a value of either 0 (off) or 1 (on). In this way, the **fax** machine translates a picture into a series of zeros and ones (called a **bitmap**) that can be transmitted like normal computer data. On the receiving side, a **fax** machine reads the incoming data, translates the zeros and ones back into dots, and reprints the picture.

The idea of **fax** machines has been around since 1842, when Alexander Bain invented a machine capable of receiving signals from a telegraph wire and translating them into images on paper. In 1850, a London inventor named F. C. Blakewell received a patent for a similar machine, which he called a *copying telegraph*.

Contrast Drills /e/ & /θ/

1. The **be**ggar held out a **ba**g.
2. Yesterday, I **me**t Mathew.
3. He **sa**id he was **sa**d.
4. His sore **le**g made him **la**g behind.
5. You've certainly **me**t your **ma**ch.
6. The baseball team **sa**ved their **be**st batter for **la**st.
7. Yes, you may **pa**t my **pe**t cat.
- 8. Ed added the ten dollars to the bet.**
9. My **ha**t makes my **he**ad hot.
10. My neighbor put up a **fa**ncy **fe**nce.

Unit 31

Spelling:

Category: Vowel → Monophthongs → Back

Initial

Medial

Doctor

Terminal

On

Cotton

Odd

Scotland

Object

Stop

Opposition

Bottle

Ostler

Box

Osmosis

Nod

Not

Odd

Shot

Wash

Phrases and Sentences

- He fond of body building.
- Doctor tried to spot the blood clot.
- George ordered to take a toss.
- All forty fought bravely.
- He bought a car.
- He waited for more than a hour.
- He caught a ball in spectacular way.

Reading Passage

Oxygen

has always been an important part of life on earth, dating back to the first signs of life millions of years ago. **O**xxygen is the 8th element on the periodic table; a gas at room temperature. To condense into a liquid, the temperature must be reduced to -182.95 degrees celsius. This temperature is much colder than the current low-temperature record here on Earth (-89.2 degrees Celsius), meaning that **o**xxygen will always be a gas under natural conditions on Earth, given there are no major environmental disruptions.

Alone, **o**xxygen is undoubtedly one of the most important elements on Earth. Humans breathe **o**xxygen; it is an essential part of human life, as well as life for many other beings. Combined with Hydrogen, another compound necessary for life is created; Dihydrogen **O**xide, better known as H₂O, or more simply as “water”. In the search for life on our planet and beyond, it is thought that water is a requirement, without which life is not possible.

As we can see, **O**xxygen is important in both the air we breathe and the water we drink; so what does this mean for evolution? First we must realize that oxygen has **not** existed in the same amounts today as it has throughout history, at least not in a usable state. **O**xxygen trapped in sediment may be more or less unusable for

millions of years until that sediment is eroded and the oxygen is released back into the atmosphere.

Today, oxygen levels in the atmosphere are around 20 percent. In earlier periods, such as the Devonian and Carboniferous, levels reached almost twice this. Organisms, whether simple or complex, are fuelled by oxygen. Higher levels of oxygen in the atmosphere equate to higher levels of oxygen in the organism's blood stream, which allows for more rapid growth. An increase in oxygen levels should therefore directly relate to the average size of the animals organisms which use oxygen.

Contrast Drills

NA

Pronunciation
Unit 32
Target Sound: “I:”
Spelling:
RP Symbol: /I:/
Category: Vowel → Monophthongs → Back

Spelling:

Category: Vowel → Monophthongs → Back

[illegible]

Phrases

- She met him at dawn to discuss the lesson that teacher had taught.
- He bought the wrought iron.
- His shirt caught fire.
- O' Henry is the author of After Twenty Years.
- He sat on the floor near the door.

Reading Passage

What is this **life**? A battle or a vision, a trial or a tale, a tempest or mid-summer night's dream. Perhaps it is both. It is the union of the two that the perfection of life consists. Thought and action are in fact, the two sides of the same coin.

One completes the other, and is completed by the other; Thought without action is an abortion and a 'treachery': action without thought is 'an arrow shot in dark'. One makes the promise, the other gives it performance. Thought illumines the goal, action reaches it. In the advancement of the world thinkers and actors share honors equally.

Thought is a prelude to action. We think and we act, we brood and we build. Shahjahan had the dream of the Taj before it became of living structure at Agra. Every great specimen of architecture or painting or statue is but the material reproduction of the artist's thoughts, and should you ask him, he would tell you that they were but poor imitations of the mental pictures from which he copied them. Whitehead says, *"Our minds build cathedrals before the workmen have moved a stone and our minds tell before elements have worn down their arches."* Every order was, thus, vision in the soul before it became an accomplished fact in history. In the beginning was the word, which means in the beginning was the idea and the idea became flesh.

Contrast Drills

NA

Unit 33

Spelling:

Category: Vowel → Monophthongs → Back

113

Phrases

- He bought a car.
- Fast cars attract the youth.
- Where can I post these parcels?
- It's ten past nine.
- It's half past nine.

Reading Passage

Write each one on a piece of card, repeating it aloud as you do so. On the other side of the card, add a symbol or simple drawing. Then take a group of cards and, looking only at your drawings, try to say the English sentences. Get into the habit of carrying a set of cards with you all the time so that you can do some revision whenever you have a spare moment.

Evils Of Wars

There is no doubt that war is an evil one. It is the greatest catastrophe that can befall human beings. It brings death and destruction, merciless slaughter and butchery, disease and starvation, poverty and ruin in its wake. One has only to think of the havoc that was wrought in various countries not many years ago, in order to estimate the destructive effects of war. A particularly disturbing side of modern wars is that they tend to become global so that they may engulf the entire world. There are, doubtless, people who consider war as something grand and heroic and regard it as something that brings out the best man. But this does not in any way alter the fact that war is a terrible dreadful calamity and this is especially true of an atomic war.

But though war is an evil, we must recognize the fact that it is a necessary, inescapable evil. A glance at the past history of the world will show war has been a recurrent phenomenon in the history of nations. No period in world history has been free from the devastating effects of war. We have had wars of all types--- wars lasting for a year or so and a war lasting for hundred years. In view of this it seems futile to talk of permanent, everlasting peace

or to make plans of the establishment of eternal peace. We have had advocates of non-violence and the theory of The brotherhood of mankind and fraternity of god. But in spite of preachers of love and non- violence, weapons have always been used, military force has always been employed. Clashes of arms have always occurred. In a world war has ways been waged. War has indeed, been such a marked feature of every age and period This has come to be regarded as part of The normal life.

Contrast Drills

NA

Pronunciation
Unit 34
Target Sound: “ I ”
Spelling:
RP Symbol: / I /
Category: Vowel → Monophthongs → Back

Spelling:

Category: Vowel → Monophthongs → Back

[illegible]

Reading Passage

School bus

The school bus is one of the most loved forms of transportation to school. The school buses of today are designed in such a way that they are more durable and more conscientiously maintained. Most school buses come in crush size and height standards and bright colors, with cross-view mirrors and reinforced sides for added safety. They also have stop sign arms and flashing red lights.

School bus drivers are also screened and required to undergo special training that involve ensuring their young passengers' safety and security, first aid and medical procedures, road safety, and other important concerns. They are also required to undergo testing for drug and alcohol consumption as well as driving record checks. Traffic laws are implemented specifically for school bus transport to make sure that students are protected.

In many cities, a school bus is a familiar sight. Students are picked up from their doorsteps and safely brought to school and back. Most school bus services are highly reliable. Most students enjoy riding on school buses instead of carpooling because they get to interact with many other students from school. They can also be as noisy as they want to be, laughing and shouting during the daily travel. It allows them to build friendships outside of the classroom. Riding a school bus will ensure that a student will not be late for school and does not have to worry about how to get home.

Contrast Drills

NA

Pronunciation
Unit 35
Target Sound: “ I ”
Spelling:
RP Symbol: / I /
Category: Vowel → Monophthongs → Back

Spelling:

Category: Vowel → Monophthongs → Back

[illegible]

Reading Passage

Leadership

Leadership is a quality which cannot be acquired by any person from the other but it can be acquired by self-determination of a person. Leadership can best be called the personality of the very highest ability-whether in ruling, thinking, imagining, innovation, warring, or religious influencing.

Leadership is a quality hidden in the personality of a human being. Human personality is very complex and it is very difficult to grade individuals according to one's personality. Leadership, on the other hand, depends on the organic structure of the personality which includes experience, skill, responsibility, intelligence, power of organizing people and social interaction. Leadership is an indispensable activity, which every leader has to perform for directing the people, working under him. It is the ability of the Leader to induce subordinates to work with confidence and zeal. In other words "Leadership is the process by which an leader imaginatively directs, guides and influence the work of others in choosing and attaining specified goals by mediating between the individuals and the organisation in such a manner, that both will obtain maximum satisfaction.

Some people have a misconception that only those people who are physically strong can become good leaders, but this is not the fact. A leader may not be physically strong but he needs to be mentally strong and firm in decisions. For example, Mahatma Gandhi, the Father of the Nation was the greatest leader but he was active and had a firm desire to serve the Nation. He had the power of organizing and uniting people and attracting people towards him by his speeches. This is the best quality of a leader which he had in him. We can also say that, a person who can satisfy the basic psychological needs of his followers can also be an effective leader.

Contrast Drills

NA

Unit 36

Spelling:

Category: Vowel → Monophthongs → Back

120

Phrases

- Earl was the first girl in the third semester.
- That work was more important for sir.
- He hurt in an accident.
- He twirled his moustache.
- On which days of the week do you work?
- On which days don't you work?

Reading Passage

The Earth was formed about 4.7 billion years ago. The Earth's shape is very close to that of a sphere, not perfectly spherical. The Earth's equatorial diameter is about 12,756 km, which is slightly larger than the polar diameter; about 12,714 km. Surface Area of the Earth is 510,065,600 km² of which 148,939,100 km² (29.2 %) is land and 361,126,400 km² (70.8 %) is water.

The Earth rotates on its axis, an imaginary straight line through its centre. The two points where the axis of rotation intersects the Earth's surface are called as the poles, one of them is called the North Pole and the other is known as the South Pole. One rotation with respect to Sun is completed in 24 hours, called a solar day.

The **Earth** rotates in counter-clock direction or from left to right-or eastward direction. Rotation serves three reasons. First, the axis of rotation serves as a reference in setting up the geographic grid of latitude and longitude. Second, it provided a good measure of the passage of time, 24 hours or 1440 minutes or 86,400 seconds a day. Third, it greatly influenced the physical and life processes on Earth.

Contrast Drills

NA

Pronunciation
Unit 37
Target Sound: “ eɪ ”
Spelling: eɪ, a, eɪ, ay, ea, ai
RP Symbol: /eɪ/
Category: Vowel → Diphthong → Front

Word Examples		
Initial	Medial	Terminal
Ale	Same	May
Ate	Lame	Pay
Age	Tame	Say
Aim	Came	Day
Able	Date	Lay
Eight	Break	Okay
April	Table	Weigh
Apron	Paper	Stay
	Place	Obey
	Case	Hurray
	Waste	They
	Crazy	Play
	Hazy	
	Lazy	
	Rain	
	Main	
	Raise	
	Neighbor	

Phrases

1. We're **late** for the **date**.
2. I want to **wake up** at **eight**.
3. I must buy **raisins**, **mayonnaise**, **cake** and **toothpaste**.
4. Don't **make** a **mistake**.
5. We **waited** at the **train station** in **May**.
6. He must **break** his **date** with his **neighbor**.
7. O.K I'll **stay** for the **day**.
8. We **ate** with **paper plates** at the picnic.
9. They **played** a **great** game.
10. Please **stay** and **wait**, so I won't be **late**.

Reading Passage

Britain is a very popular **holiday** destination and millions of tourists visit the country every year. They come to see the cities with their museums, theatres, historical sites and buildings, or the country side with the pretty villages, woods, lakes and hills.

Some British people who love in the city have a second home in the country side or by the sea where they go for weekends or longer holidays. Other people just rent a cottage in the countryside when they want to get away from the city. Young people can go on activity holidays where they do sports and spend time outdoors. On most bank holidays the traffic on the roads to the popular holiday locations gets very busy and traffic jams can be a problem for holidaymakers.

Contrast Drills /eɪ/ /e/

- Here we are on our holiday.
- We stayed in a little cottage.
- We are staying in Scotland and we are coming home.
- Unfortunately it rained every day
- We are in Wales this week.

Pronunciation
Unit 38
Target Sound: “I I “
Spelling: o, ow, ov, oe
RP Symbol: /I I /
Category: Vowel → Diphthong → Back

Word Examples		
Initial	Medial	Terminal
Owe	Soap	So
Own	Toast	Hello
Only	Roast	Ago
Over	Coat	No
Old	Boat	Snow
Oak	Boast	Show
Open	Nose	Blow
Omit	Note	Throw
Obey	Both	Though
Ozone	Wrote	Dough
OK	Don't	Toe
	Won't	Foe
	Coke	Joe
	Hope	
	Hole	
	Rope	
	Home	
	Knows	

Phrases

1. **Go** answer the **phone** call from **Rome**.
2. Please **note**, we must be ready to **go** in a **moment**.
3. **Joe** **drove** **home** from the party with **Joan**.
4. **Most** **older** people **don't** feel **old**, they just look **old**.
5. **Don't** **throw** a **snowball** when it's below **zero**.
6. The root of corporate culture is corporate **soul**.
7. Please **don't** **go** **home** **so** soon-it's **only** eleven o'clock.
8. Let the golf ball **roll** into the **hole**.
9. Joe told that awful **joke** **over** and **over**.
10. **Smoke** **rose** and **rose** into the **ozone**.
11. **Joe** is **almost** through in his work.
12. We were **frozen** **cold** in the winter storm.
13. The **host** and **hostess** served a **roast** and **potatoes**.
14. It is **below** **zero** today-- it will **snow**.

Contrast Drills

1. **Don't** **hold** the **hot** **rock**.
2. **Maude** sewed her **socks**.
3. The **ocean** is **becoming** calm.
4. **Bob** wrote a **note** to **Chuck**.
5. We heard a **shot** and **shut** the door.
6. When they **awoke**, they took a **walk**.
7. **Ducks** **sometimes** swim **under** the **dock**.
8. He'll be **hot** **without** a hat and **coat**.
9. I **saw** her sew the **socks** and **clothes** with a needle and thread.
10. They **got** their examination **results** in the **old** building.
11. The **hull** of the **old** boat was **caught** **on** a large **rock**.
12. I tore a **hole** in my **old** coat, so it **must** be sewn **up**.

Pronunciation
Unit 39
Target Sound: “ aɪ ”
Spelling: ov, ow
RP Symbol: / aɪ /
Category: Vowel → Diphthong

Word Examples		
Initial	Medial	Terminal
Out	Brown	Now
Outfit	Crowd	Cow
Our	Down	How
Hour	Tower	Allow
Ounce	Announce	Brow
Bounce	Mountain	Eyebrow
Ouch	Mouse	Anyhow
	Cloud	
	Shout	
	House	
	Tower	
	Power	
	Flower	
	Clown	
	Town	
	Pronounce	
	Thousand	
	Sour	

Phrases and Sentences

1. **Out** and about.
2. Don't **allow** that **clown** into **our town**.
3. A **mound** of **flowers** **surrounds** the **house**.
4. No **doubt**, he will come.
5. The **mouse** lives in the **house**.
6. **Down** by the **brown tower**, a **crowd** awaits the **announcement**.
7. **Flower power** has **soured**.
8. It's **crowded around** the **house**.
9. They don't **allow** **shouting**.
10. I will **pronounce** all the **vowels**.
11. The **sour flour** weighs an **ounce**.
12. **Ouch!** That hurts.

Contrast Drills

NA

Pronunciation**Unit 40**

Target Sound: “ aɪ ”

Spelling: aɪ, y, ie

RP Symbol: / aɪ /

Category: Vowel → Diphthongs

Word Examples

Initial	Medial	Terminal
I	Five	Pie
Eye	Arrive	Lie
I'm	Alive	Die
I've	Fire	Tie
I'd	Find	Cry
I'll	Life	Dry
Island	Like	Rye
Ice	Alike	Deny
Isle	Mind	Why
	Nine	My
	Fried	Fly
	Cried	By
	Type	High
	Style	Sigh
	Wild	
	Bite	
	Light	
	Right	
	Night	
	Sight	
	Height	
	Delight	
	Frighten	

Phrases

1. Hi! Nice to meet you.
2. Today, I'll try for my driver's license.
3. I'll be working from nine to five. How about you?
4. That's a sigh of relief.
5. My father has wise foresight.
6. How are you? I'm fine. Thank you.
7. It's about time to learn to fly by myself.
8. I'll have an aisle or a window seat.
9. On Friday, I would like to take a nice drive.
10. Indian cooking is highly spiced.

Reading Passage

Student Life

It is said that “student life is golden life,” because student life is the most important part of human life. It is the period of pure joy and happiness, because the mind of a student is free from cares and worries of a grown-up life. In this period, the character of man is built. So, it is called the formative period of human life. Every student should try his best to make the best use of his student life. The primary duty of a student is to learn and to acquire knowledge. He must do all his work at the right moment and maintain punctuality and discipline. He must remember that if a student becomes successful in his student career and his character is built on a sound basic, he will be able to shine in any sphere of life and serve his society and countries.

A student should spend most of his time of this golden period in reading and learning. A good student never waste his time fixed for reading uselessly. But he must not be a book-worm being always engaged in his studies. He should also be careful about his health and spend some time daily in some sports and games. He should try to develop his body and mind at the same time. As a

student he must try to develop his intellect. He should also try to acquire some good qualities like obedience, dutifulness, respect on elders and love and sympathy for fellow man in the society. The duty of a student is to obey his parents and teachers and respect the elders of the society.

Students are the future hope of country. So every student should try to be the best citizen in all respect, so that he may serve his country as far as he can.

Contrast Drills
NA

Pronunciation
Unit 41
Target Sound: “II”
Spelling: oi, oy
RP Symbol: / II /
Category: Vowel → Diphthongs

Word Examples		
Initial	Medial	Terminal
Oil	Coin	Boy
Oily	Foil	Joy
Ointment	Broil	Toy
	Toil	Annoy
	Join	Annoyed
	Noise	Enjoy
	Soil	Destroy
	Choice	Destroyed
	Coil	Employ
	Avoid	Employed
	Royal	
	Poison	
	Voice	
	Spoil	
	Sirloin	
	Point	
	Invoice	

Phrases
1. Roy is very annoyed. 2. The toy boy jumped for joy. 3. Please check my oil, Roy, but please don't toil with my oil tank. 4. The boy broiled the sirloin and oysters in oil. 5. Mr. Hoyle destroyed the decoy. 6. Invoice Detroit, Joyce. 7. The noise spoiled the music. 8. We can't avoid the noise which drowns out our voices. 9. Joyce pointed to her choice, to avoid confusion. 10. I was annoyed by their loud voices.
Reading Passage
Importance of Voice "Voice" refers to the ability to engage in meaningful conversation, to make a difference through what one says, and to have a say in key decisions. According to John Paul Lederach, voice centers on inclusive conversations that are grounded in "mutuality, understanding and accessibility". When parties have a voice, their viewpoints, thoughts, and feelings receive a "fair hearing" and are readily recognized by others. They possess the capacity to make an impact, both on their own personal situation as well as the broader struggle, through their actions and words. This need to be heard and recognized is connected to people's sense of justice and their desire for validation. This capacity to "have a say" may amount to having a seat at the negotiating table (or being adequately represented by someone who does), an opportunity to hold office, a chance to vote, or an opportunity to provide input into important decisions. At the local level, gaining a voice may mean serving as a representative on planning boards and committees within one's community. Those whose voices are most often silenced include women, minority groups, indigenous peoples, and the poor.
Contrast Drills
NA

Pronunciation

Unit 42

Target sound :ɪɪ

Spelling :e ” “or é a ”

RP Symbol :ɪɪ / /

Category Vowel → Diphthongs

Word Examples

Initial	Medial	Terminal
Ear	Serious	Idea
earrings	Mysterious	sincere
Earmark	Experience	severe
Earlobes	theater	appear
		fear
		Hear
		seer

Phrases

1. The **area** is not cleaned.
2. An authentic **material** is required to learn English sounds.
3. **Here is** a book, take it.
4. The third **period** is allotted for English Language Lab.
5. It is the **experience** which corrects us.
6. The beer sold **hear** and near the pier tastes **weird** , yet we really **fear** its hard to steer clear.

Pronunciation

Unit 43

Target Sound : eɪ

Spelling : "e" or "e-a"

RP Symbol : /eɪ/

Category : Vowel → Diphthongs

Word Examples

Initial	Medial	Terminal
Air	Pairs / pares	care
Airplane	Tears	dare
Aerodrome	Wherever	spare
Aerospace	Hairsplitting	wear
bare	chairs	hair
		fare
		Dare
		Pair
		Yeah
		there

Phrases

1. The **airplane** took off smoothly and is now sailing gracefully in the sky.
2. We need **air** and water to live.
3. The bus **fare** is recently hiked.
4. There **are** various courses available by MOOCS.
5. Beware of the **bear** whose only care to eat your **fare** and who is **rarely** snared or **dared** especially when in pairs.

Pronunciation

Unit 44

Target Sound : I I

Spelling : "u", "ou" or "o-o"

RP Symbol : /I I/

Category : Vowel → Diphthongs

Word Examples

Initial	Medial	Terminal
	Tourist	insure
	Cruel	poor
	During	Newer
	Insurance	endure
	curious	lure
		Tour
		Sure
		Cure
		fewer

Phrases

1. The **poor** are not **sure** of their meal tomorrow.
2. There was a lot of **security** during PM's arrival.
3. There is no **cure** for this disease.
4. The steward **endured touring** the moors, then cruelly **lured** the poor tourists seeking a cure into deep sewers.

VOWEL SEQUENCE (TRIPHTHONGS)

The term vowel sequence refers to the use of more than two vowels (called triphthongs) in a word. Triphthongs are those sounds that consist of a movement or glide from one vowel to second vowel and then onto a third. They are very similar to diphthongs, but have an extra schwa /Y/ the end. The following vowel sequences or triphthongs are used in English :

The triphthongs can be looked on as being composed of the five closing diphthongs described in the last section, with a added on the end. Thus we get:

eI+I = eII

I I + I = I I I

aI + I = aI I

aI + I = aII

I I + I = I I I

The principal cause of difficulty for the foreign learner is that in present-day English the extent of the vowel movement is very small, except in very careful pronunciation. Because of this, the middle of the three vowel qualities of the triphthong (that is, the I or I part) can hardly be heard and the resulting sound is difficult to distinguish from some of the diphthongs and long vowels. To add to the difficulty, there is also the problem of whether a triphthong is felt to contain one, or two syllables. Words such as 'fire' faII or 'hour' I I I are probably felt by most English speakers (with BBC pronunciation) to consist of only one syllable, whereas 'player' peII or 'slower' slII I I are more likely to be heard as two syllables.

We will not go through a detailed description of each triphthong. This is partly because there is so much variation in the amount of vowel movement according to how slow and careful the pronunciation is, and also because the "careful" pronunciation can be found by looking at the description of the corresponding diphthong and adding I to the end. However, to help identify these triphthongs, some example words are given here:

eII 'layer', 'player'

I I I 'lower', 'mower'

aII 'liar', 'fire'

aI I 'power', 'hour'

I I I 'loyal', 'royal'

S O U R C E

http://didattica.uniroma2.it/assets/uploads/corsi/135762/Lessons_7_+_9.Long_vowels_and_diphthongs_.pdf

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